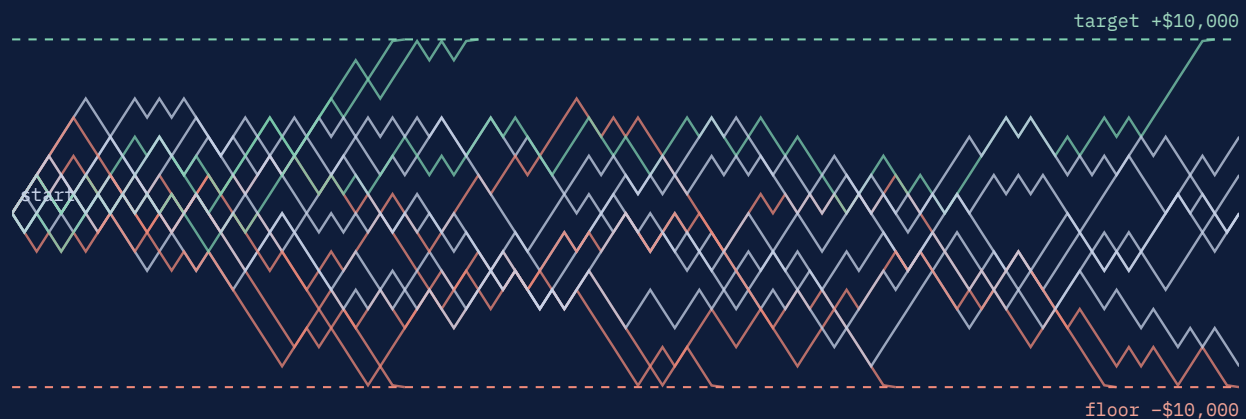


# The Prop Firm Option

Why a funded-account challenge has positive expected value for a trader with no predictive skill, exactly how large that value is, how to get it as fast as possible, how far it scales per person, and how to run it inside every firm's written rules.



Part 1 · The mathematics, from zero

Part 2 · Execution, step by step

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Educational analysis, not financial advice. Prop-firm accounts are simulated and payouts ("rewards") are paid at the firm's discretion under its terms. Every figure in this document assumes the firm pays. In the execution plan about seven attempts in ten lose their full fee; the first month is usually negative, and individual results vary enormously. Firms change rules and prices often; check the current terms before acting. Prop firms require traders to be adults (18+). Do not use money you cannot afford to lose.

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# Key results at a glance

Version 4 re-runs every figure on price paths with the firms' rules as written, checks every rule that touches the plan (Chapter 23), adds four more firms and better programmes, and simulates one person running all accounts at once in lockstep. "Zero skill" means no trade direction is better than chance. Every figure assumes the firms pay every payout.

## VERSION 5 UPDATE (4 OCTOBER 2026): READ PART 3 FIRST

- Six of the eleven firms in version 4 have had their TrustPilot rating withheld for fake reviews** (Alpha Capital, BrightFunded, Blue Guardian, FunderPro, Maven, GFT). Version 5 sorts firms into tiers and prices in a chance that payouts are refused (Chapter 33).
- Two firms added** with clean public records: Fintokei (4 accounts) and Hola Prime (2 accounts on USDJPY, because it forbids copying from other firms). OANDA Prop Trader no longer exists; five other candidates were flagged and left out (Chapter 34).
- Recommended per person: tier A and B firms, plus one account at each tier-D firm** (23 accounts at 13 firms): \$100,000 per steady month if every payout is paid, \$62,000 under the tiered refusal scenario. Version 4's full caps fell from \$114,000 to \$52,000 under the same scenario (Chapter 35).
- Tier A only (11 accounts): \$52,000 all paid, \$39,000 tiered. All tiers at full caps (31 accounts): \$136,000 and \$63,000. Futures (Topstep 5, Apex 20 at 90% off) add \$21,000 all paid but only \$4,000 tiered.
- Each 10% fee discount adds 2–4% per account (Chapter 34.4).

| Quantity                                                                                                              | Value                                                                    | Where         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Chance a zero-skill trader passes FTMO Phase 1 / both phases (the plan)                                               | 47% / 30%                                                                | Ch. 3–4, 29   |
| The plan: Nasdaq, one position, stop 0.75 hourly moves, <b>1 : 5</b> , risk 1.5%, funded cycles of the full allowance | \$1,644 per FTMO attempt, 11.8 days                                      | Ch. 19, 24    |
| <b>EV per month per FTMO 100K slot (synthetic / real path)</b>                                                        | <b>\$4,200 / \$4,300</b>                                                 | <b>Ch. 20</b> |
| Best programme found: FundingPips 2-Step Flex, 95%                                                                    | \$6,100 per month per slot                                               | Ch. 20        |
| Several positions at once (Nasdaq + S&P, many pairs)                                                                  | no gain at the same risk                                                 | Ch. 18        |
| 100K vs 200K accounts, per dollar of allowance                                                                        | about the same; 50K worse                                                | Ch. 19        |
| Futures programmes                                                                                                    | small or negative; left out                                              | Ch. 20        |
| <b>Per person, one account at each of 11 firms (default)</b>                                                          | <b>\$49,100 per steady month</b>                                         | <b>Ch. 21</b> |
| ... chance ahead after 1 / 3 / 12 months; bad-case cash low                                                           | 31% / 90% / 100%; –\$47K                                                 | Ch. 21, 30    |
| Per person, full caps (25 accounts)                                                                                   | \$113,600 per steady month; up to 12 failed accounts a month at one firm | Ch. 21        |

| Quantity                                                             |                                          | Value                     | Where  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|---------------------------|--------|
| Per person, FTMO only (4 × 100K or 2 × 200K)                         |                                          | \$17,400 per steady month | Ch. 21 |
| Rule audit: firms where only one account may carry the plan's trades | GFT, FunderPro, FundedNext (gold), FXIFY |                           | Ch. 23 |
| If each payout had a 5% chance of being refused (and the firm lost)  |                                          | -23% of the value         | Ch. 31 |

#### WHAT CHANGED IN VERSION 4

- 1. Rules as written.** Gaps through the daily limit, weekend and overnight rules, profitable days that may not be manufactured, best-day caps: all enforced. The5ers fell by about a quarter; futures got weaker.
- 2. Copying rules decide the shape.** GFT, FunderPro, FundedNext (funded) and FXIFY limit or forbid the same trades on several of their accounts: one account each.
- 3. One account per firm by default.** Eleven firms with one account each give about three times FTMO-alone's value with a similar bad-case cash low, and only about two failed accounts a month at each firm.
- 4. New and better products:** FundingPips Flex 95% (12% allowance), Blue Guardian, BrightFunded, FunderPro, Maven.
- 5. Lockstep test:** 1,200 simulated years of one person running every account on one price path; no two accounts ever held opposite positions.
- 6. Private use only.** The same rules traded by several people would be prohibited group trading.

## PART 1

# The mathematics

Everything is built from two facts: a fair game stays fair however you play it, and money paid out has to come from somewhere. No prior knowledge of probability or trading is assumed.

# The contract you are buying

A proprietary trading firm ("prop firm") sells evaluations. You pay a fee and receive a **simulated** trading account. Nothing you trade reaches a real market and you can never lose more than the fee. If you meet the firm's targets without breaking its loss limits, you get a "funded" account, still simulated, on which the firm pays you a share of the profits you make. Those payments are called *rewards* or *payouts*.

We use FTMO's 100K 2-Step Challenge as the worked example throughout. Chapter 11 extends the analysis to 37 account types at 16 firms.

| Stage                     | You must reach                                            | You fail if                                                  | Other rules                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Phase 1<br>(Challenge)    | \$110,000 (+\$10,000)                                     | Equity $\leq$ \$90,000, or<br>you lose \$5,000 in one<br>day | At least 4 trading days; no time limit                                                                                                  |
| Phase 2<br>(Verification) | \$105,000 (+\$5,000),<br>starting again from<br>\$100,000 | Same: floor \$90,000,<br>\$5,000 per day                     | At least 4 trading days; no time limit                                                                                                  |
| Funded (FTMO<br>Account)  | No target                                                 | Same floor and daily<br>limit                                | You keep 80% of withdrawn profit; first payout after<br>14 days, then every 14 days; the €540 fee is<br>refunded with your first payout |

Source: FTMO trading objectives and FAQ, October 2026. The maximum loss is *static*: the floor stays at \$90,000 however high the balance goes.

## Words you need

- **Balance** is the account value counting only closed trades. **Equity** also counts the open trade's floating profit or loss. FTMO's limits are checked on equity, in real time.
- **Maximum loss (the floor)**. If equity touches \$90,000 the account is closed. We call the distance from the current balance down to the floor B (it starts at \$10,000).
- **Daily loss limit**. You may not lose more than \$5,000 (5% of the starting balance) within one day, measured from the balance at midnight Prague time, open trades included.
- **Profit target**. The distance from the current balance up to the target is called A.
- **Profit split**. The share of withdrawn profit you keep: 80% at FTMO (90% through its scaling plan).
- **Stop-loss and take-profit**. Orders that close a trade automatically at a loss of S dollars or a profit of T dollars. A trade with both attached is called a **bracket**. Its **reward-to-risk ratio (RR)** is  $T : S$ .

## Why this is an option, and what kind

Your worst case is losing the fee. Your best case has no fixed ceiling. A payoff with a capped downside and an open upside is what finance calls an *option*, and the fee is its price. The question this document answers is whether the option is worth more than its price to someone who cannot

predict the market. Chapters 2 to 6 show that it is, and by how much. Note what this does *not* say. The value does not come from "volatility" in general, and it does not depend on trading in any clever way. Chapter 5 shows exactly where it comes from.

# Probability from zero

## 2.1 Probability and expected value

A **probability** is a number between 0 and 1 saying how often something happens in the long run. A fair coin lands heads with probability  $\frac{1}{2}$ .

The **expected value** (EV) of a bet is the average result per bet if you repeated it many times. You get it by multiplying each outcome by its probability and adding up.

### EXPECTED VALUE

$$EV = p_1 \times outcome_1 + p_2 \times outcome_2 + \dots$$

*Example.* You win \$10 on heads and lose \$10 on tails:  $EV = \frac{1}{2} \times 10 + \frac{1}{2} \times (-10) = 0$ . You win \$20 on heads and lose \$10 on tails:  $EV = \frac{1}{2} \times 20 - \frac{1}{2} \times 10 = +\$5$ .

Expected values **add up**. The EV of ten bets is the sum of their ten EVs, whether or not the bets are connected to each other. This one fact will matter a lot in Chapter 13 (hedging).

## 2.2 Fair games

A bet is **fair** when its EV is zero. A game made of fair bets has a remarkable property: **no way of choosing your bets can change the fact that your expected total is zero**. You can bet big or small, stop when ahead, double after losses. If every individual bet is fair, the expected result of the whole sequence is still zero. Mathematicians call such a process a *martingale*, and the formal version of this fact is the *optional stopping theorem*. Its conditions (bets of bounded size, and a stopping rule that ends the game in finite expected time) are all met by the rules in this document.

## 2.3 One trade is one bet

Suppose you buy EURUSD and attach a stop 50 pips below and a target 50 pips above. If you have no information about direction, the price is as likely to reach either level first. The bet wins \$T or loses \$S. What is the probability  $p$  of winning?

With no skill, the price process has no drift, so the trade is a fair bet before costs: its EV must be zero.

### WIN PROBABILITY OF A ZERO-SKILL BRACKET

$$p \times T - (1 - p) \times S = 0 \Rightarrow p = S \div (S + T)$$

| Risk : reward | Stop S  | Target T | Win probability $S/(S+T)$ |
|---------------|---------|----------|---------------------------|
| 1 : 0.1       | \$5,000 | \$500    | 90.9%                     |
| 1 : 1         | \$5,000 | \$5,000  | 50.0%                     |
| 1 : 2         | \$5,000 | \$10,000 | 33.3%                     |

| Risk : reward | Stop S  | Target T | Win probability $S/(S+T)$ |
|---------------|---------|----------|---------------------------|
| 1 : 3         | \$5,000 | \$15,000 | 25.0%                     |

Higher reward always comes with lower probability, in exactly the proportion that keeps the bet fair. A big target is not "better" and a small one is not "safer". They are the same bet with a different shape.

## 2.4 Does real data agree?

We tested this on every hour of EURUSD from 18 December 2023 to 2 October 2026. Each test trade picks a random direction and a random entry hour on a weekday, then follows the real price until the stop or target is hit. The results below are before costs.

| Stop / target (pips) | Fair value $S/(S+T)$ | Measured win rate | 95% range |
|----------------------|----------------------|-------------------|-----------|
| 25 / 25              | 50.0%                | 50.4%             | $\pm 0.7$ |
| 50 / 50              | 50.0%                | 50.3%             | $\pm 0.7$ |
| 55 / 55              | 50.0%                | 49.7%             | $\pm 0.6$ |
| 100 / 100            | 50.0%                | 50.0%             | $\pm 0.7$ |
| 78 / 39 (1 : 0.5)    | 66.7%                | 67.6%             | $\pm 0.5$ |
| 39 / 78 (1 : 2)      | 33.3%                | 32.1%             | $\pm 0.5$ |
| 25 / 100 (1 : 4)     | 20.0%                | 20.3%             | $\pm 0.5$ |

The formula holds closely. Symmetric brackets come out at 50% within noise. There is a small tilt in this sample: far targets (1 : 2) hit about one point less often than fair, and near targets slightly more often, which is mild short-term mean reversion. That is one reason Part 2 uses 1 : 1. The earlier documents claimed an "effective win rate" of 48.5%. The data does not support it. The only systematic drag is the trading cost, which Chapter 7 handles separately.

# Reaching a target before a floor

Each challenge phase asks one question: starting from your current balance, will you reach the target (A dollars above) before you hit the floor (B dollars below)? This is the oldest problem in probability, known as the *gambler's ruin*.

## 3.1 The answer in one line

Let  $P$  be the probability of reaching the target first. The game ends in one of two places:  $+A$  with probability  $P$ , or  $-B$  with probability  $1 - P$ . Every trade is fair, so by Section 2.2 the expected final result must be zero, no matter how you traded:

GAMBLER'S RUIN, EXACT

$$P \times A - (1 - P) \times B = 0 \Rightarrow P = B \div (A + B)$$

For FTMO Phase 1,  $A = B = \$10,000$ , so  $P = 10,000 \div 20,000 = \mathbf{50\%}$ . For Phase 2,  $A = \$5,000$  and  $B = \$10,000$ , so  $P = 10,000 \div 15,000 = \mathbf{66.7\%}$ .

## 3.2 Checking it by hand

Take a tiny version: steps of \$1, target +2, floor -2. From 0 you need two net wins before two net losses. Call  $P_x$  the chance of passing from  $x$ . Then  $P_2 = 1$ ,  $P_{-2} = 0$ , and every middle point is the average of its neighbours:  $P_x = \frac{1}{2}P_{x+1} + \frac{1}{2}P_{x-1}$ . The only numbers that are "the average of their neighbours" lie on a straight line, so  $P_x = (x + 2) \div 4$  and  $P_0 = \frac{1}{2}$ , exactly as the formula says.

## 3.3 The value of the phase is a straight line

The same argument works from any balance  $x$  between the floor and the target:

PASS PROBABILITY FROM BALANCE  $x$

$$P(x) = (x + B) \div (A + B) \quad (x \text{ measured from the starting balance})$$

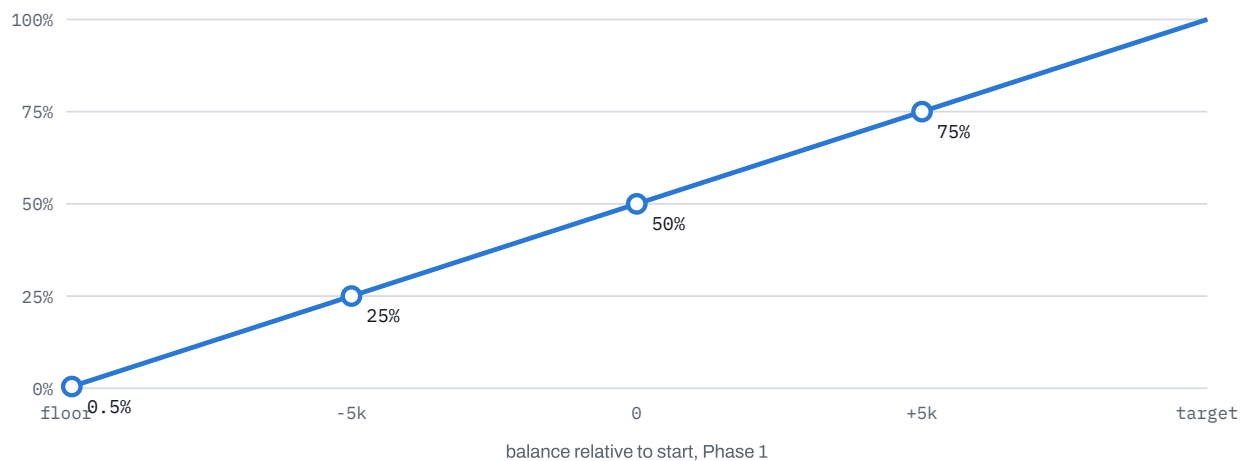


Figure 3.1 · Chance of passing Phase 1 from each balance. It is a straight line from 0 at the floor to 1 at the target, whatever the sizing.

At  $-\$9,900$  in Phase 1, with only  $\$100$  left above the floor, your chance is  $100 \div 20,000 = 0.5\%$ . You can only risk  $\$100$  there, and the formula already accounts for that: it is the room left above the floor that sets the probability.

### 3.4 What does not change the answer

Look at what the formula does not contain: no bet size, no reward-to-risk ratio, no number of trades, no volatility. **As long as every trade is fair and the account ends exactly on the target or exactly on the floor, the pass probability is  $B \div (A + B)$ .** Sizing up after losses, sizing down near the floor, 1 : 1 versus 1 : 3: none of it moves the number. Sizing only changes how many trades it takes, and Chapter 7 shows that the number of trades is what you pay for in costs.

This also means the earlier documents' central claim, that the challenge pays off because "variance is rewarded" (Jensen's inequality), is the wrong explanation. With no time limit, more variance does not raise the pass probability at all. Variance only helps when there is a deadline.

### 3.5 What does change it: overshoot

The formula assumes the account lands exactly on a barrier. If your last winning trade carries you *past* the target, the extra profit is wasted, and the pass probability falls. If your last losing trade carries you *past* the floor (a price gap through your stop), the firm absorbs the extra loss, and the pass probability rises.

#### GAMBLER'S RUIN WITH OVERTSHOOT

$$P = (B + O_{\text{floor}}) \div (A + O_{\text{target}} + B)$$

*Example.* The earlier documents traded a fixed  $\pm\$4,800$  at 1 : 1. Two wins reach only  $+\$9,600$ , which is short of the  $\$10,000$  target, so a third net win is needed and the account effectively has to reach  $+\$14,400$ . Then  $P \approx 10,000 \div (14,400 + 10,000) = 41\%$  instead of 50%. Choosing a fixed size without looking at the target costs nine percentage points.

**RULE FROM CHAPTER 3**

Size every trade so that a win lands exactly on the target and a loss lands no lower than the floor. Under that rule the pass probability is fixed at  $B \div (A + B)$ , and the only thing left to optimise is cost.

# The challenge, step by step

The cheapest way to land exactly on a barrier is to use as few trades as possible. Within FTMO's \$5,000 daily loss limit that means risking up to \$5,000 per trade and aiming the take-profit straight at the target. Mathematicians call this **bold play**. Here is the complete tree.

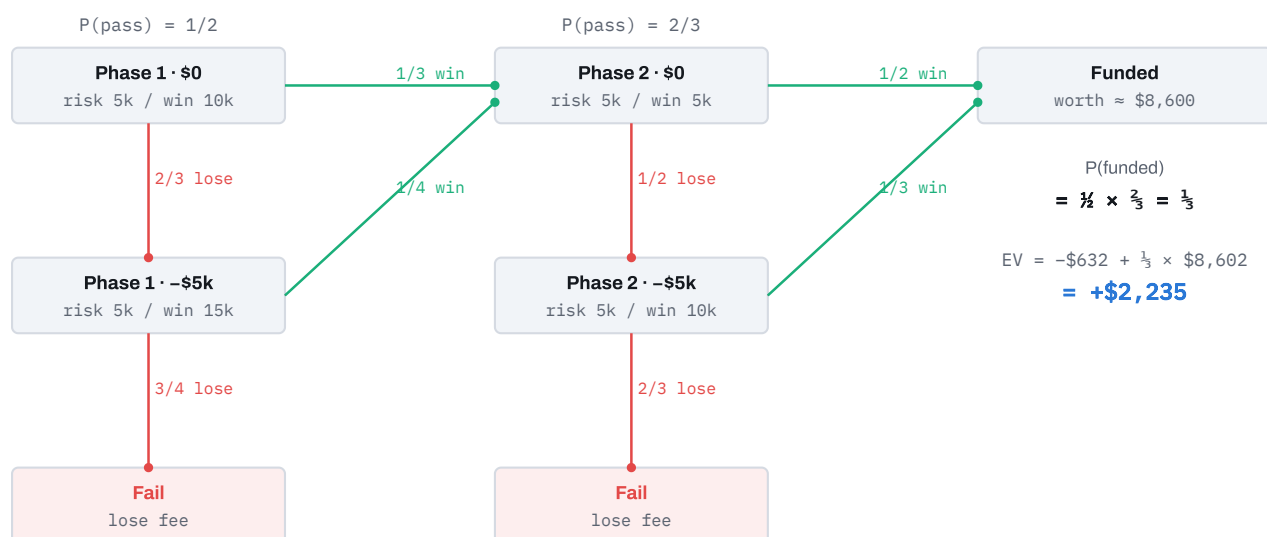


Figure 4.1 · Bold play through both phases. Each trade risks the daily limit and aims exactly at the target.

## 4.1 Phase 1

| Where you are      | Trade                                 | Win chance | If it wins | If it loses      |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------|------------|------------|------------------|
| Day 1, at \$0      | Risk \$5,000, target \$10,000 (1 : 2) | 1/3        | Pass       | Balance -\$5,000 |
| Day 2, at -\$5,000 | Risk \$5,000, target \$15,000 (1 : 3) | 1/4        | Pass       | Floor: fail      |

$$P(\text{pass Phase 1}) = 1/3 + (2/3) \times (1/4) = 1/3 + 1/6 = 1/2$$

Check it with plain 1 : 1 trades of \$5,000 instead. Two wins in a row pass (1/4). Two losses in a row fail (1/4). One of each brings you back to \$0 (1/2), where you start again. So  $P = 1/4 + 1/2P$ , which gives  $P = 1/2$ . It is the same answer, as Chapter 3 promised. Bold play just gets there in at most two trades.

## 4.2 Phase 2

| Where you are      | Trade                                 | Win chance | If it wins | If it loses      |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------|------------|------------|------------------|
| Day 1, at \$0      | Risk \$5,000, target \$5,000 (1 : 1)  | 1/2        | Pass       | Balance -\$5,000 |
| Day 2, at -\$5,000 | Risk \$5,000, target \$10,000 (1 : 2) | 1/3        | Pass       | Floor: fail      |

$$P(\text{pass Phase 2}) = 1/2 + (1/2) \times (1/3) = 2/3 \quad P(\text{funded}) = 1/2 \times 2/3 = 1/3$$

### 4.3 Details the tree hides

- **Minimum trading days.** If you pass on day 1 or 2, you still need 4 trading days. Place a tiny trade (for example 0.01 lots with a 5-pip stop) on the remaining days. It changes nothing measurable.
- **The daily limit includes open losses.** Keep each stop a little under \$5,000 (the real-data test used \$4,850) so spread and slippage cannot breach the limit.
- **Phases are independent.** Phase 2 starts again from \$100,000, so its 2/3 does not depend on how Phase 1 went.
- **This is the theoretical optimum, not the Part 2 plan.** Risking the full daily limit on one trade aimed at the target is what FTMO's conduct rules call overexposure or a one-sided bet (Chapter 17). Part 2 keeps risk at 1.5% per trade and gets its speed from the instrument and the stop size instead (Chapters 8–10).

# What a funded account is worth

Once funded, there is no target. You trade, withdraw profits every 14 days, keep 80%, and the account continues until equity hits the \$90,000 floor. How much do you expect to collect in total?

## 5.1 An accounting identity

Follow the money. Every dollar withdrawn from the account came either from trading profit or from the balance going down. Over the whole life of the account:

FUNDED-ACCOUNT IDENTITY (ALWAYS TRUE)

$$Total\ withdrawn = Total\ trading\ profit + (Starting\ balance - Final\ balance)$$

The account ends when the balance reaches the floor, so  $Starting - Final = \$10,000$ . With zero skill, total trading profit is a sum of fair bets, whose expected value is zero (Section 2.2; the stopping conditions hold because the account is reset to \$100,000 at every payout, which guarantees it ends in finite expected time). Taking expectations:

EXPECTED PAYOUT OF A FUNDED ACCOUNT

$$E[total\ withdrawn] = 0 + \$10,000 = \$10,000 \Rightarrow \text{you receive } 80\% \times \$10,000 = \$8,000 \text{ (minus costs)}$$

In words: **the firm's expected payout equals the loss allowance it gives you.** You keep 80% of every dollar you withdraw, and the firm pays every dollar of loss down to the floor. In a fair game, the dollars won balance the dollars lost, and the losses stop at exactly \$10,000. This is the true source of the option's value. It does not depend on how you trade.

## 5.2 Simulated check: trading style does not matter

| Funded-account trading style                         | Avg paid, no costs | Avg paid, 1.4% costs | Chance of any payout |
|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|----------------------|----------------------|
| Bold: risk \$5k, aim +\$500 first, then +\$5k cycles | \$8,779 ± 137      | \$8,340              | 95%                  |
| 1% risk, 1 : 1, every day                            | \$8,579 ± 136      | \$7,080              | 79%                  |
| 5% risk, 1 : 2, every day                            | \$8,171 ± 241      | \$7,541              | 27%                  |

20,000 simulated funded accounts per row. Each figure is \$8,000 plus the refunded fee times the chance of at least one payout (the refund only arrives with a first payout). Costs reduce the payout most for the style that trades most.

## 5.3 Why the earlier "expected maximum = \$10,000" claim is false

The earlier documents argued that a fair walk with a floor \$10,000 below reaches an expected maximum of \$10,000. The chance that it ever climbs  $m$  dollars before the floor is  $10,000 \div (10,000 + m)$ , which falls so slowly that the expected maximum is *infinite*. The correct reason the payout

averages \$10,000 is the identity in 5.1, which depends on withdrawing profits. It also shows that their simulated averages of \$10,271 (which would mean \$12,839 withdrawn) and  $13.6\% \times \$22,000$  (which would mean \$8,985 to you per funded account) are impossible with zero skill.

## 5.4 The refund and the first payout

The €540 fee comes back with your first payout, so it pays to make the first payout very likely. Aim first for a small profit  $h$ . The chance of reaching  $+h$  before the floor is  $10,000 \div (10,000 + h)$ . With  $h = \$500$  that is 95.2%. Once you reach  $+\$500$ , stop trading until the payout date, collect \$400 plus the refund, then continue normally. The refund adds about  $0.95 \times \$632 \approx \textbf{\$600}$  to the funded value, for a total of about **\$8,600**.

# Putting it together

## VALUE OF ONE ATTEMPT

$$EV = -\text{Fee} + P(\text{pass 1}) \times P(\text{pass 2}) \times \text{Funded value}$$

$$= -\$632 + \frac{1}{2} \times \frac{2}{3} \times \$8,602 = -\$632 + \$2,867 = +\$2,235$$

## 6.1 Every possible outcome of one attempt

With bold play in the funded account, each payout cycle after the first pays \$4,000 with probability 2/3 and ends the account with probability 1/3 (the same tree as Phase 2). That makes the full distribution exact:

| Outcome                                  | Probability | Net result       |
|------------------------------------------|-------------|------------------|
| Fail Phase 1                             | 50.0%       | -\$632           |
| Pass Phase 1, fail Phase 2               | 16.7%       | -\$632           |
| Funded, but bust before the first payout | 1.6%        | -\$632           |
| First payout (\$400 + refund), then bust | 10.6%       | +\$400           |
| ... plus one \$4,000 cycle               | 7.1%        | +\$4,400         |
| ... plus two cycles                      | 4.7%        | +\$8,400         |
| ... plus three cycles                    | 3.1%        | +\$12,400        |
| ... plus four or more                    | 6.3%        | +\$16,400 and up |
| <b>Expected value</b>                    | <b>100%</b> | <b>+\$2,235</b>  |



Figure 6.1 · One FTMO 100K attempt under bold play, no costs. The expected value is positive, but the most likely single outcome is losing the fee.

The EV is large, but the typical outcome is a loss: 68% of attempts lose the whole fee. The value sits in a long right tail. That shape is why Chapter 12 (bankroll) matters as much as the EV itself.

## 6.2 If it is this good, why does the firm survive?

On a perfect zero-skill trader, FTMO expects to pay out about \$2,870 for every \$632 fee. Firms survive for three reasons.

- **Most customers are far worse than random.** Industry estimates put real Phase 1 pass rates at 10–15%, against 46–50% for a low-cost coin flip. The difference is mostly trading costs from many small trades with tight stops (Chapter 7), plus abandoning live accounts.
- **Rules remove convexity where it is cheap to remove:** trailing drawdowns, consistency rules, payout caps (Chapter 11).
- **Payouts are discretionary**, and the conduct rules target exactly the fastest version of the strategy (Chapter 16).

# Trading costs

Every trade pays the **spread** (the gap between buying and selling price), a **commission**, and sometimes **slippage** (being filled worse than your stop price). Costs are the only thing in this model that turns fair bets into losing ones.

## 7.1 Measuring cost per trade

For EURUSD on FTMO, a realistic all-in cost is about 0.75 pip per round trip: roughly 0.15 pip of raw spread, 0.5 pip of commission (about \$5 per standard lot) and 0.1 pip of average slippage. What matters is the cost *relative to the stop*. We call this ratio  $\kappa$  (kappa):

### COST RATIO

$$\kappa = \text{cost in pips} \div \text{stop distance in pips} \quad \text{e.g. } 0.75 \div 55 \approx 1.4\%$$

A trade risking \$1,000 with a 55-pip stop costs about \$14. The same \$1,000 risk with a 10-pip stop needs 5.5 times the position size, so it costs about \$75 ( $\kappa = 7.5\%$ ).

## 7.2 Costs as a drift

A cost of  $c$  dollars per trade turns the fair bet into one with  $EV = -c$ . The pass formula becomes, approximately:

### PASS PROBABILITY WITH COSTS

$$P \approx (B - \text{expected total cost}) \div (A + B)$$

## 7.3 Why the number of trades is what you pay for

With fair trades of size  $L$  (risk  $L$ , target  $L$ ), the expected number of trades to finish a phase is  $A \times B \div L^2$ . Each costs about  $\kappa \times L$ , so:

### EXPECTED TOTAL COST OF A PHASE

$$\text{Cost} \approx \kappa \times L \times (A \times B \div L^2) = \kappa \times A \times B \div L$$

| Phase 1 with $\kappa = 1.4\%$              | Risk per trade $L$ | Expected trades | Expected cost      | P(pass)                   |
|--------------------------------------------|--------------------|-----------------|--------------------|---------------------------|
| Bold play (Chapter 4)                      | \$5,000            | $\approx 1.7$   | $\approx \$180$    | 48.9%                     |
| Slow 1% plan (version 1)                   | \$1,000            | $\approx 100$   | $\approx \$1,400$  | $\approx 44\text{--}45\%$ |
| Scalper, 10-pip stops ( $\kappa = 7.5\%$ ) | \$500              | $\approx 400$   | $\approx \$15,000$ | $\approx 0\%$             |

The scalper's expected costs exceed the whole loss allowance. This one line explains most of the gap between the textbook 50% and the industry's 10–15%.

## 7.4 How to keep costs low

- **Wide stops are cheap but slow.** A stop of about one day's range keeps  $\kappa$  near 1–1.5% on EURUSD, but each trade then lasts days. Chapter 11 shows how to trade cost against time.
- **Liquid instruments and hours.** EURUSD during the London and New York sessions has the tightest spreads.
- **Avoid scheduled news.** Rate decisions, US payrolls and CPI cause slippage on stops.
- **Swap.** Holding overnight earns or pays a small interest charge. With ~1–2 day trades it is minor, but check your platform's swap table.

With  $\kappa \approx 1.4\%$  applied to every trade, the simulated EV of the bold plan falls from +\$2,272 to **+\$2,081** (100,000 simulated attempts).

# Time: how long an attempt takes

Expected value per attempt is only half the story. If one plan earns \$1,400 per attempt and needs 86 weeks, and another earns \$1,400 and needs 3 weeks, the second is worth almost thirty times more per month. This chapter derives how long each phase takes and which choices make it faster.

## 8.1 How many trades a phase needs

Take fair trades that risk  $L$  and aim for  $k \times L$  (reward-to-risk 1 :  $k$ ). Each trade adds a random amount with mean zero and variance  $k \times L^2$ . A second fair-game identity (Wald's) says the expected squared final result equals the expected number of trades times the variance per trade. The final result is  $+A$  with probability  $B \div (A + B)$  and  $-B$  otherwise, so its expected square is  $A \times B$ .

EXPECTED NUMBER OF TRADES IN A PHASE

$$N = A \times B \div (k \times L^2)$$

FTMO Phase 1 ( $A = B = \$10,000$ ) with 1% risk and 1 : 1 needs about 100 trades. With 1.5% risk and 1 : 3 it needs about  $10,000 \times 10,000 \div (3 \times 1,500^2) \approx 15$  trades.

## 8.2 How long one trade takes

A bracket closes when price moves a distance  $s$  against you or  $k \times s$  in your favour. If the price moves with volatility  $\sigma$  per hour (its typical one-hour move), the same identity applied to price gives:

EXPECTED DURATION OF ONE BRACKET

$$T_{trade} \approx k \times s^2 \div \sigma^2 \quad \text{hours}$$

A stop of one hourly move ( $s = \sigma$ ) at 1 : 1 takes about one active hour. A stop of three hourly moves takes about nine.

## 8.3 Time and cost of a whole phase

Multiply the two. The reward-to-risk ratio  $k$  cancels:

PHASE TIME AND PHASE COST

$$Time \approx A \times B \times s^2 \div (L^2 \times \sigma^2) \quad Cost \approx A \times B \times c \div (k \times L \times s)$$

Here  $c$  is the round-trip cost as a fraction of price. These two lines contain every lever:

| Lever              | Effect on time                                                  | Effect on cost | Limit                                                     |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Risk per trade $L$ | Falls with $L^2$ : 1.5% is 2.25× faster than 1%                 | Falls with $L$ | Firm guidance: FTMO suggests 1–1.5%                       |
| Stop distance $s$  | Rises with $s^2$                                                | Falls with $s$ | The trade-off you optimise                                |
| Reward-to-risk $k$ | No effect                                                       | Falls with $k$ | Overshoot near the target; real-data drift at far targets |
| Instrument         | Sets the price of speed: cost $c$ against movement $\sigma$     |                | Chapter 9                                                 |
| Leverage           | None, unless it forces a wider stop than you want (Section 9.3) |                | Rarely binds                                              |

## 8.4 The speed–cost trade-off

A tighter stop finishes the phase sooner but costs more per dollar risked. If the expected value per attempt falls roughly in a straight line with cost,  $EV \approx EV_0 - \beta/s$ , and time grows like  $s^2$ , then EV per unit time is  $(EV_0 - \beta/s) \div s^2$ . Setting its derivative to zero gives  $s = 1.5 \beta \div EV_0$ , where EV is one third of  $EV_0$ .

### THE SURPRISING RULE

When time is what matters, the best stop is tight enough that trading costs eat about **two thirds** of the no-cost expected value. Fixed waiting times (minimum days, reviews, the 14-day payout calendar) push the optimum back towards wider stops, because once those waits dominate, more speed buys little. Chapter 10 finds the real optimum by simulation.

## 8.5 Fixed waits you cannot trade away

- **Minimum trading days:** 4 per phase at FTMO, 3 at FundingPips and The5ers, 5 at FundedNext.
- **Reviews:** about 1 day between phases and 1–3 days for identity checks and the contract before funding.
- **The payout calendar:** FTMO's first payout comes 14 days after your first funded trade, then every 14 days. FundingPips offers weekly payouts at a 60% split. FundedNext's first cycle is 21 days. Crypto firms such as Breakout and HyroTrader pay on demand.

These waits set a floor. Even the fastest pass cannot produce an FTMO payout much sooner than about 25 days after purchase: 4 + 4 minimum trading days, about 4 days of reviews, then 14 days to the first payout date.

# Instruments, leverage and platforms

## 9.1 The one number that ranks instruments

From Section 8.3, for a fixed time budget, the cost you pay is proportional to  $c \div \sigma$ : the trading cost compared with how far the instrument moves. Over a full trading week this becomes:

### INSTRUMENT EFFICIENCY

*Efficiency = typical weekly move  $\div$  round-trip trading cost (higher = faster for the same cost)*

Weekly movement already includes trading hours. An instrument that trades 24/7 gets credit for its weekend movement automatically, so "crypto trades all week" is already counted.

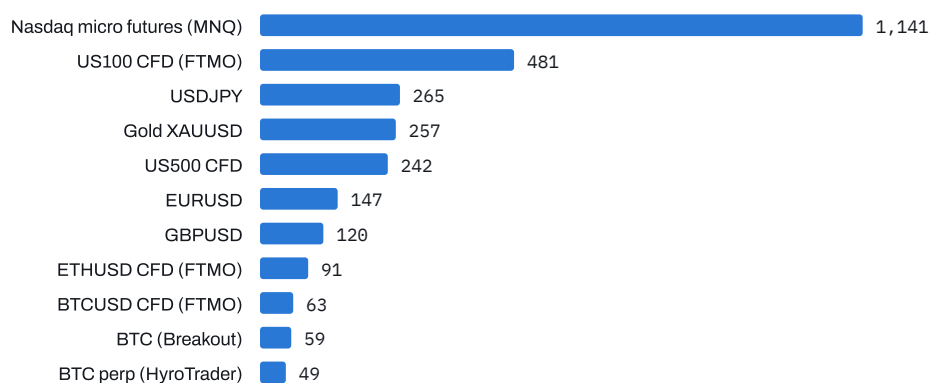


Figure 9.1 · Weekly move divided by round-trip cost. Higher means an instrument can be traded faster for the same cost.

| Instrument (platform)                          | Weekly move  | Round-trip cost | Efficiency | Max leverage | Hours/week  |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------|--------------|-------------|
| Nasdaq 100 micro futures (futures firms)       | 3.08%        | 0.0027%         | 1,141      | –            | ~110        |
| <b>US100 CFD (FTMO, zero commission)</b>       | <b>3.08%</b> | <b>0.0064%</b>  | <b>481</b> | <b>1:50</b>  | <b>~110</b> |
| USDJPY (FTMO)                                  | 1.35%        | 0.0051%         | 265        | 1:100        | ~118        |
| Gold XAUUSD (FTMO)                             | 2.78%        | 0.0108%         | 257        | 1:30         | ~110        |
| US500 CFD (FTMO)                               | 2.32%        | 0.0096%         | 242        | 1:50         | ~110        |
| EURUSD (FTMO)                                  | 0.91%        | 0.0062%         | 147        | 1:100        | ~118        |
| GBPUSD (FTMO)                                  | 0.91%        | 0.0076%         | 120        | 1:100        | ~118        |
| ETHUSD CFD (FTMO, 0.0325%/side commission)     | 9.52%        | 0.105%          | 91         | 1:3.3        | 168         |
| BTCUSD CFD (FTMO)                              | 5.89%        | 0.093%          | 63         | 1:3.3        | 168         |
| BTC (Breakout/Kraken, 0.04%/side)              | 5.89%        | 0.10%           | 59         | 1:5          | 168         |
| BTC perp (HyroTrader/Bybit, taker 0.055%/side) | 5.89%        | 0.12%           | 49         | up to 1:100  | 168         |

Weekly move: standard deviation of weekly returns, hourly data 2023–26. Costs: published FTMO spreads (US100 1.66 pts, gold \$0.52, EURUSD raw spread plus \$3/lot commission), exchange fees for crypto firms, plus an allowance for slippage. Futures: about \$1.70 per micro contract round trip. Check your own platform: Chapter 18.

## 9.2 Crypto: trading 24/7 does not help

Bitcoin moves about six times as much as EURUSD in a week, partly because it trades on weekends. But on prop platforms it costs fifteen to twenty times as much per trade, because crypto carries percentage commissions (0.0325% per side at FTMO, 0.04% at Breakout, 0.055% taker at Bybit). Its efficiency ends up between a half and a tenth of the alternatives. Chapter 10 confirms it: the best crypto set-up found earns about a fifth of the Nasdaq plan per month.

## 9.3 What leverage actually does

Leverage does not make trades resolve faster. Time depends on how far price must travel (the stop distance) compared with how fast it moves. Leverage only limits position size, and so sets the *tightest* stop you can use for a given risk:

TIGHTEST STOP ALLOWED BY LEVERAGE  $\lambda$

$$s_{min} = \text{risk per trade} \div (\lambda \times \text{account size}) \quad 1.5\% \text{ risk at } 1:50 \rightarrow 0.03\%; \text{ at } 1:3.3 \rightarrow 0.45\%$$

For indices, metals and currencies the limit is far below any sensible stop. For crypto at FTMO (1:3.3), 0.45% is just above one hourly Bitcoin move, so leverage would block the fastest crypto stops. Costs make those stops unattractive anyway.

## 9.4 Overnight financing

Positions held through the daily rollover pay (or occasionally earn) financing on their full size. With tight stops the position is large, so even one night can cost several percent of the risk on index and gold CFDs. Fast plans close most trades within hours, which keeps this small. The simulations charge it on every rollover crossed.

## 9.5 Futures

Futures are the cheapest instrument of all, but futures prop firms use trailing drawdowns, small accounts (\$2,000 allowance on 50K), payout ladders and consistency rules (Chapter 11). Their value per account is small, though attempts are quick and some firms allow many accounts at once.

# Maximising expected value per month

## VERSION 4 NOTE

This chapter is version 2's analysis. Chapters 17–23 redo it on price paths with the firms' rules as written and find a better plan (1 : 5, funded cycles of the full allowance) and higher values per month. Where the figures differ, Chapters 17–23 hold.

## 10.1 Method

For each instrument we measured, on real hourly data, how long random-direction brackets of each size actually take (including waiting for trading hours and weekends) and how often they cross the rollover. Those measured durations then drive a full simulation of each firm's contract with calendar time:

- Daily loss limits, minimum days and reviews.
- Payout calendars and refunds.
- A daily guard that stops trading before the daily limit can be breached.

Every set-up was simulated 1,200–4,000 times. The trades are assumed to have **no edge**: the small win-rate deviations seen in the data were treated as noise. The result is *expected value per month per account slot* = expected value per attempt ÷ average length of an attempt.

## 10.2 Stop size

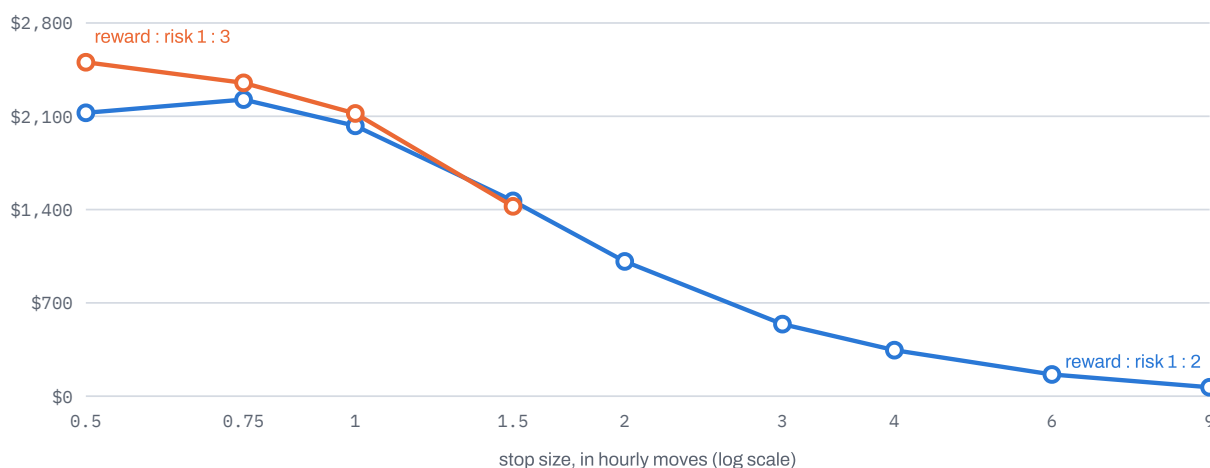


Figure 10.1 · EV per month per slot against stop size. FTMO 2-Step, US100, 1.5% risk, zero edge. The best stops are short.

The best stop is short: about **0.5–1 hourly move**, which is 40–85 Nasdaq points. At 0.75 hourly moves, costs take roughly 40% of the no-cost value, which matches the trade-off of Section 8.4 once the fixed payout waits are included. Very wide stops (the earlier plan used about six hourly moves on EURUSD) are thirty times slower.

## 10.3 Reward-to-risk, risk per trade and payout policy

| FTMO 2-Step, US100                                          | EV per attempt  | Days per attempt | EV per month   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------|----------------|
| Stop 1 hourly move, 1 : 1, risk 1.5%                        | +\$880          | 22               | \$1,236        |
| Stop 1 hourly move, 1 : 2, risk 1.5%                        | +\$1,469        | 22               | \$2,029        |
| Stop 1 hourly move, 1 : 3, risk 1.5%                        | +\$1,402        | 20               | \$2,122        |
| Stop 0.75 hourly moves, 1 : 3, risk 1.0%                    | +\$1,234        | 25               | \$1,503        |
| <b>Stop 0.75 hourly moves, 1 : 3, risk 1.5%</b>             | <b>+\$1,355</b> | <b>18</b>        | <b>\$2,351</b> |
| Same, funded target +\$3,000 per cycle instead of +\$10,000 | +\$1,526        | 25               | \$1,892        |

- **Reward-to-risk 1 : 2 or 1 : 3** beats 1 : 1 by a wide margin. As Section 8.3 predicts, it costs no time and cuts the number of trades.
- **1.5% risk** beats 1%, also as predicted (time falls with  $L^2$ ). Both are inside FTMO's 1–1.5% guidance; this plan does not go above it.
- **Funded payout policy.** Aim for a large profit per 14-day cycle (+\$10,000) rather than a small one. Fewer cycles mean the account resolves sooner. The first cycle still aims for +\$1,000 to secure the fee refund.

## 10.4 Instrument

| FTMO 2-Step, best set-up per instrument | EV per month per slot |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>US100 (Nasdaq CFD)</b>               | <b>\$2,350–2,500</b>  |
| Gold (XAUUSD)                           | \$2,071               |
| USDJPY                                  | \$1,814               |
| US500                                   | \$1,467               |
| EURUSD                                  | \$1,179               |
| GBPUSD                                  | \$781                 |
| ETHUSD CFD                              | \$299                 |
| BTCUSD CFD                              | \$83                  |

## 10.5 Firm

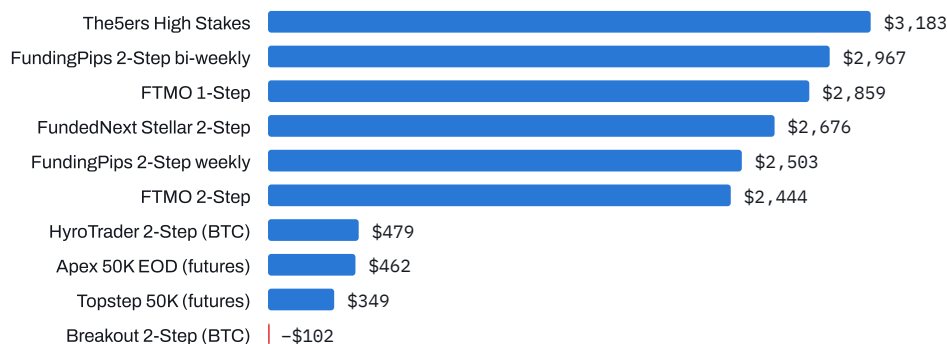


Figure 10.2 · EV per month per account slot, best set-up found for each programme (zero edge, payouts honoured).

| Firm and programme (100K, US100 plan)   | EV per attempt  | Days per attempt | EV per month   | Median days to first payout |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------|------------------|----------------|-----------------------------|
| The5ers High Stakes                     | +\$1,869        | 18               | \$3,183        | 23                          |
| FundingPips 2-Step, bi-weekly 80%       | +\$1,743        | 18               | \$2,967        | 23                          |
| FTMO 1-Step                             | +\$1,755        | 19               | \$2,859        | 23                          |
| FundedNext Stellar 2-Step               | +\$1,866        | 21               | \$2,676        | 34                          |
| FundingPips 2-Step, weekly 60%          | +\$1,171        | 14               | \$2,503        | 16                          |
| <b>FTMO 2-Step</b>                      | <b>+\$1,429</b> | <b>18</b>        | <b>\$2,444</b> | <b>27</b>                   |
| Apex 50K EOD (futures, MNQ, \$500 risk) | +\$148          | 10               | \$462          | 13                          |
| HyroTrader 2-Step (BTC, 3% risk)        | +\$571          | 36               | \$479          | 28                          |
| Topstep 50K (futures, MNQ, \$500 risk)  | +\$76           | 7                | \$349          | 12                          |
| Breakout 2-Step (BTC)                   | -\$250          | 75               | -\$102         | 78                          |

±\$170–210 on EV per attempt for the CFD firms (4,000 simulations each). The same Nasdaq costs were assumed at every CFD firm; their real spreads may differ. Futures values are per 50K account.

The CFD firms with an 8% Phase 1 target (The5ers, FundingPips) come out ahead of FTMO 2-Step's 10%. The FTMO 1-Step's 90% split and resetting floor also beat it. The weekly 60% payout option pays sooner but less. The crypto firms and Breakout's 6% drawdown with a 10% Phase 2 target are poor contracts.

## 10.6 Check on real prices

We re-ran the winning FTMO set-up on the actual 2024–26 Nasdaq price path, with every bracket resolved on real bars:

| Real-path test, FTMO 2-Step (1,500 attempts each)      | EV per attempt        | Days      | EV per month   |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------|----------------|
| <b>US100, stop 0.75 hourly moves, 1 : 3, 1.5% risk</b> | <b>+\$2,076 ± 372</b> | <b>19</b> | <b>\$3,281</b> |
| Same, trading costs × 1.5                              | +\$1,596 ± 322        | 18        | \$2,688        |
| US100, stop 1 hourly move, 1 : 2                       | +\$1,675 ± 355        | 22        | \$2,289        |

| Real-path test, FTMO 2-Step (1,500 attempts each) | EV per attempt | Days | EV per month |
|---------------------------------------------------|----------------|------|--------------|
| EURUSD, stop 1 hourly move, 1 : 3                 | +\$1,214 ± 282 | 18   | \$2,004      |

Real prices came out above the zero-edge model. Part of that is favourable noise: in this sample, far targets were hit slightly more often than fair odds. Plan with the zero-edge numbers, about **\$2,400 per month per FTMO 2-Step slot**.

## 10.7 What one account slot looks like over a year

| One FTMO 100K slot, fast plan, rebuying after each attempt | 1 month  | 3 months  | 6 months  | 12 months |
|------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| Chance of being ahead                                      | 5%       | 36%       | 69%       | 88%       |
| Average result                                             | -\$1,757 | +\$1,088  | +\$7,781  | +\$23,110 |
| Median result                                              | -\$1,896 | -\$1,560  | +\$5,344  | +\$20,584 |
| Bad case (10th percentile)                                 | -\$3,160 | -\$5,056  | -\$6,616  | -\$1,272  |
| Good case (90th percentile)                                | -\$632   | +\$13,008 | +\$23,872 | +\$49,648 |

2,000 simulated years. Fees are counted when paid; payouts are counted at the end of each attempt (slightly pessimistic timing). About 1.6 attempts per month per slot, so roughly \$1,000 a month in fees.

# Other firms and other rule types

## VERSION 4 NOTE

This chapter is version 1's firm comparison. Chapters 17–23 redo it on price paths with the firms' rules as written and find a better plan for every major firm (Chapter 20). Where the figures differ, Chapters 17–23 hold.

Every challenge can be valued with the same two tools: a pass probability for each phase, and the identity for the funded account. What changes between firms is the shape of the floor and the payout rules.

## 11.1 Static floor

FTMO 2-Step and most forex/CFD 2-Steps work as in Chapters 3–5:  $P = B \div (A + B)$  per phase, funded value  $\approx \text{split} \times B$ .

## 11.2 End-of-day (EOD) trailing drawdown

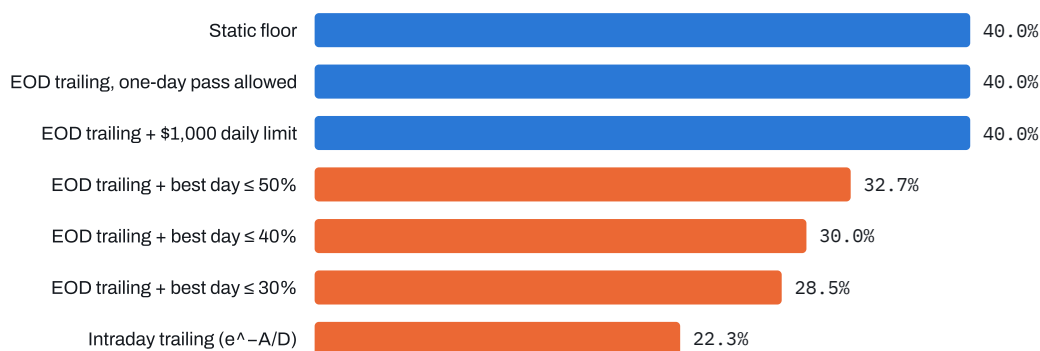
The floor rises whenever a day closes at a new high, and stays there. If you can pass in a single day, the floor never moves and you get the static answer. Firms add **consistency rules** ("your best day may not exceed X% of total profit") to force several profitable days, each of which lifts the floor.

## 11.3 Intraday trailing drawdown

The floor follows your highest *live equity*, including unrealised profit. With prices that move continuously, the best possible chance of reaching A before a drawdown of D from the peak is:

INTRADAY TRAILING, ANY STRATEGY

$P = e^{-A/D}$  (for driftless prices, the peak reached before a drawdown of D is exponentially distributed with mean D)



maximum pass probability, \$3,000 target, \$2,000 drawdown

Figure 11.1 · How each rule type changes the best achievable pass probability (dynamic programming; intraday is the continuous-price bound).

## 11.4 Funded accounts with locks and caps

Futures firms typically start the funded floor at the same trailing distance, then "lock" it at the starting balance plus about \$100 once you are far enough ahead. They also cap payouts (for example Apex closes the account after six payouts). The identity still holds, so the funded value is  $\text{split} \times (\text{expected start} - \text{final balance})$ . Locks and caps reduce it, typically to around \$1,500 on a \$2,000 allowance, and to about \$700 when the trail is intraday.

## 11.5 The ranking

We valued 37 account types at 16 firms the same way: zero skill, best sizing for each rule set, 1% trading costs, payouts honoured. The full table is in Appendix B.

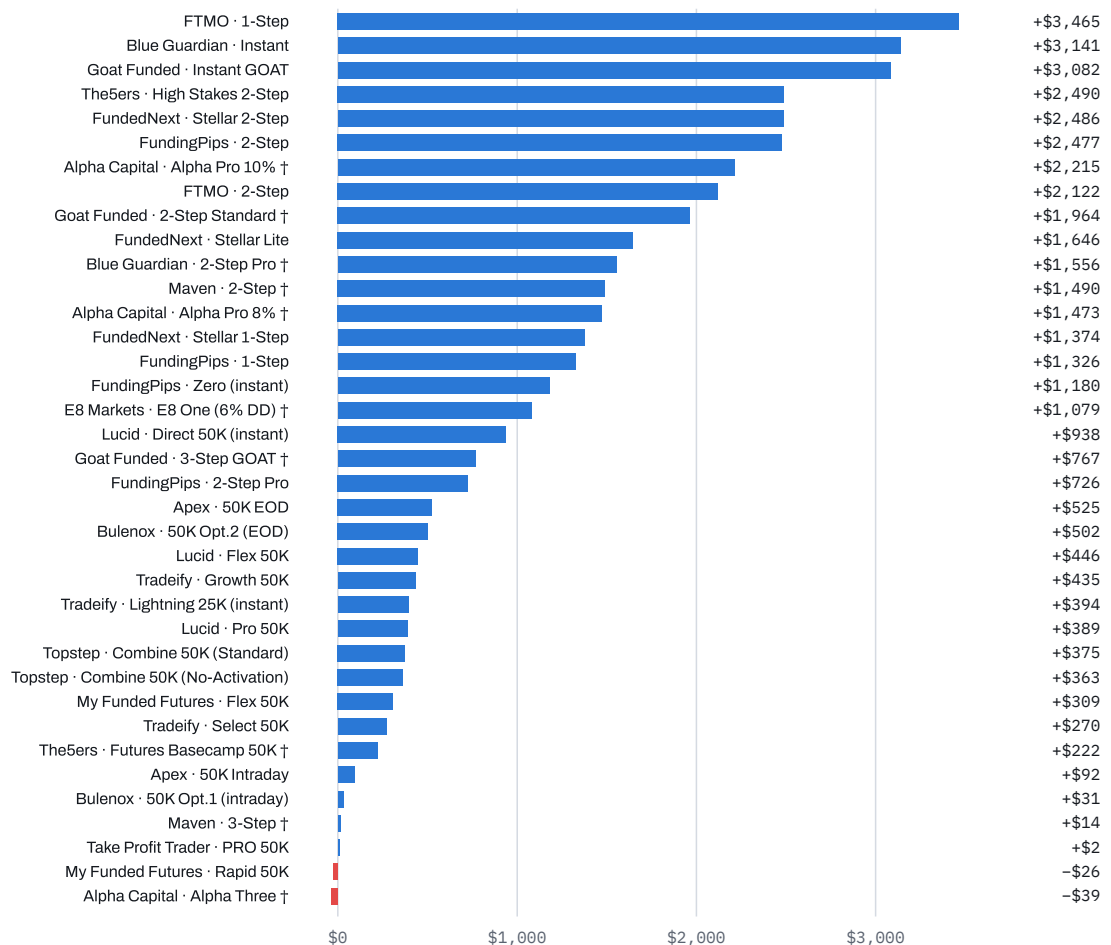


Figure 11.2 · Expected value per attempt, zero skill, 1% costs, payouts honoured. † rule set partly inferred.

- **Static 10% 2-Steps** (FundedNext, FundingPips, The5ers, FTMO): +\$2,000 to +\$2,500 per attempt.
- **FTMO 1-Step** ranks first (+\$3,465): its trailing floor resets with each payout and the split is 90%.
- **Futures evaluations** are cheap and return the most per dollar of fee, but each is worth only \$300–\$550.
- **Intraday trailing** accounts and **3-step** programmes are worth close to nothing, or less.
- **Instant-funding** values are upper estimates: their payout caps and consistency rules were not fully modelled.

# Variance, bankroll and Kelly

A positive EV only shows up after many attempts. Because most attempts lose the fee and a few pay a lot, you need enough money to survive the losing runs.

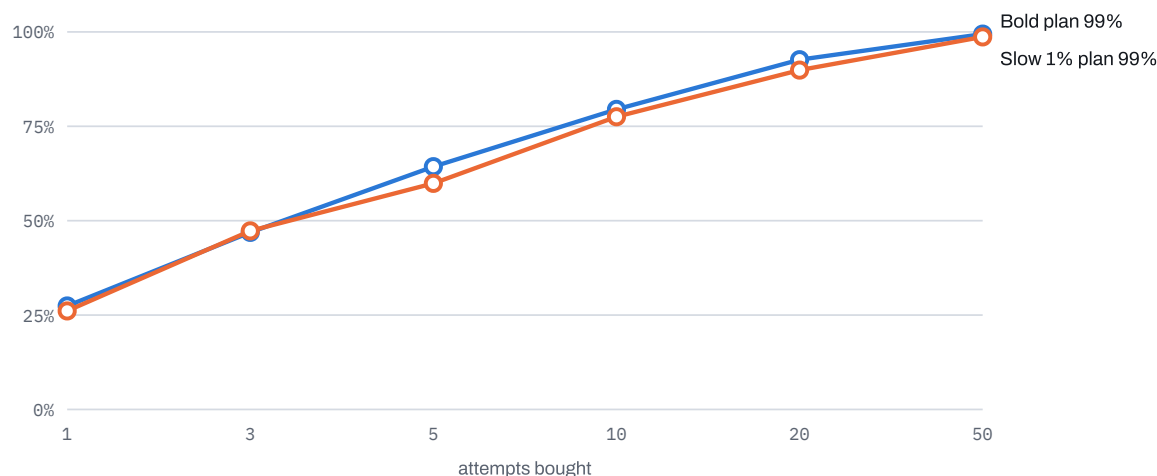


Figure 12.1 · Chance of being ahead after buying n FTMO 100K attempts (real EURUSD data, bootstrap).

| Attempts bought                     | 1   | 3   | 5   | 10  | 20  | 50  |
|-------------------------------------|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| Chance of being ahead, bold plan    | 27% | 47% | 64% | 79% | 93% | 99% |
| Chance of being ahead, slow 1% plan | 26% | 47% | 60% | 78% | 90% | 99% |

Bootstrap from 6,000 (bold) and 3,000 (slow 1% plan) simulated attempts on real EURUSD data. The fast plan of Part 2 is shown month by month in Section 10.7.

## 12.1 Risk of ruin

If you start with a fixed amount and buy attempts until you either run out of fees or complete 100 attempts, the chance of running out (bold plan, real data) is 53% with 3 fees (\$1,896), 35% with 5 fees (\$3,160), 11% with 10 fees (\$6,320) and 1.2% with 20 fees (\$12,640). The slow 1% plan is riskier per attempt, because more of its attempts lose: 22% ruin with 10 fees and 5% with 20.

## 12.2 The Kelly criterion, done correctly

The Kelly criterion picks the bet size that makes your wealth grow fastest over time. For a bet with mean gain  $\mu$  and variance  $\sigma^2$  per unit staked, the growth-optimal stake is roughly  $\mu \div \sigma^2$  of your wealth. For a fixed-size bet such as one challenge, this inverts: the bankroll at which buying one attempt is growth-optimal is about  $\sigma^2 \div \mu$ .

### BANKROLL FOR ONE ATTEMPT AT FULL KELLY

$W \approx \sigma^2 \div \mu$  exact log-growth on the real-data outcomes:  $\approx \$4,100$  (bold) and  $\approx \$6,000$  (slow 1% plan)

The earlier documents computed  $\mu \div \sigma^2 = 1.4 \times 10^{-5}$ , treated it as a fraction of wealth, and concluded you need \$40 million. The units are wrong:  $\mu \div \sigma^2$  is "per dollar", not a percentage. Half-Kelly (about \$8,000–12,000) is a sensible minimum for someone who wants smaller swings.

# Hedging

The idea is to take opposite positions in two accounts, at the same firm, at two firms, or against a personal brokerage account, so that one account's loss is the other's gain.

## 13.1 Hedging cannot create value

Expected values add (Section 2.1). The expected total of several accounts is the sum of their individual EVs, however their results are linked. If each account is worth +\$2,235, a hedged pair is worth exactly +\$4,470. If each were worth −\$100, hedging would lock in −\$200. A hedge changes only the *spread* of outcomes.

## 13.2 The values are straight lines, so a hedge can be exact

With a static floor, the value of each stage is a straight line in its own balance (Section 3.3):

| Stage (no costs) | Value at start | Value per \$1 of balance (slope) |
|------------------|----------------|----------------------------------|
| Funded account   | \$8,602        | 0.80                             |
| Phase 2          | \$5,735        | $8,602 \div 15,000 = 0.573$      |
| Phase 1          | \$2,867        | $5,735 \div 20,000 = 0.287$      |

Holding an opposite position equal to the slope makes the total value constant. For example, two Phase 1 accounts with opposite positions (equal target and floor distances) always produce exactly one pass, and a personal account holding  $0.287\times$  the opposite exposure locks in \$2,867 − \$632 per attempt. Mathematically, hedging turns the lottery of Chapter 6 into a near-certain cash flow.

## 13.3 Why it does not work in practice

- **It is prohibited.** FTMO's forbidden-practices page bans opposite positions across accounts, explicitly including "accounts held with various operators/providers", with forfeiture of rewards and termination of all agreements. Most firms have equivalent clauses.
- **It cannot protect against a refused payout.** Against your own brokerage account, the paths where the prop account wins are exactly the paths where your real money lost. If that payout is refused, the loss is real, up to \$8,000 per funded account, where the unhedged loss would only have been the fee.

Hedging is therefore covered here only to explain the mathematics. It is not part of the execution plan.

# Testing it on real market data

## 14.1 Method

Data: hourly EURUSD bars, 18 December 2023 to 2 October 2026 (730 trading days). Each simulated attempt starts on a random date and opens each trade at a random weekday hour between 07:00 and 16:00 UTC, in a random direction. Brackets resolve on real highs and lows. When one hourly bar touches both stop and target, a coin flip decides (this cannot bias the result). Costs are 0.75 pip per round trip. FTMO's daily and maximum loss limits, minimum days, 14-day payout cycles, 80% split and refund are all applied. Funded accounts run until they hit the floor. When the data runs out it wraps to the start.

## 14.2 Results

| Strategy                                                                     | EV per attempt        | P(pass 1)    | P(funded)    | P(profit)    | Avg length        |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|-------------------|
| Bold play (Chapter 4), 6,000 attempts                                        | +\$1,764 ± 161        | 46.4%        | 29.5%        | 28.0%        | ≈ 6 weeks         |
| <b>Slow 1% plan (version 1): 1% risk, 1 : 1, 3,000 attempts</b>              | <b>+\$1,398 ± 193</b> | <b>45.0%</b> | <b>27.2%</b> | <b>26.1%</b> | <b>≈ 86 weeks</b> |
| Same with 1 : 2 targets                                                      | +\$1,368 ± 209        | 38.2%        | 23.2%        | 22.2%        | ≈ 44 weeks        |
| Earlier PDFs' protocol (±\$4,800, 1 : 1, quit after 2 losses, daily flatten) | -\$173 ± 79           | 14.6%        | 8.2%         | 3.5%         | –                 |

± values are 95% confidence ranges. "Avg length" counts market time from purchase to the end of the attempt (failure, or the funded account hitting its floor).

The real-data figures sit a little below the cost-only model (+\$2,081 for bold play). The gap comes from the safety buffer kept above the floor, hourly resolution, and the mild mean reversion seen in Section 2.4. The sign and size are confirmed. The fast plan of Part 2 was tested the same way in Section 10.6.

## 14.3 Why the earlier protocol loses

| Earlier protocol variant                                                    | EV per attempt | P(funded) |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|-----------|
| As written: quit Phase 1 after 2 full losses, flatten before New York close | -\$70 ± 90     | 8.8%      |
| Quit rule kept, no daily flatten                                            | +\$404 ± 165   | 14.8%     |
| No quit rule, daily flatten kept                                            | +\$884 ± 152   | 22.1%     |
| Neither                                                                     | +\$672 ± 178   | 19.9%     |

The quit rule is the main damage. A live account is always worth  $(x + B) \div (A + B)$  of the next stage's value (Section 3.3), so abandoning it throws that value away. After a win-win-loss-loss sequence, for instance, you are back at \$0 with a full 50% chance, and the rule tells you to quit. The fixed ±\$4,800 size adds the overshoot loss of Section 3.5.

# Errors in the earlier "Convex Edge" documents

For readers coming from the earlier "FTMO Convex-EV" / "Convex Edge" PDFs, this is what changes and why.

| Earlier claim                                                                             | Correct statement                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Status              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| The edge comes from variance via Jensen's inequality; EV rises with $\sigma^2$ .          | With no deadline, the pass probability is $B/(A+B)$ for any $\sigma$ . The edge is the loss allowance (Chapter 5).                                                                                                                       | wrong mechanism     |
| A fair walk's expected maximum before the floor equals the floor distance.                | It is infinite. The funded value follows from the withdrawal identity.                                                                                                                                                                   | false               |
| Funded payout \$10,271 at 80% split; EV +\$3,223 / +\$2,502.                              | Implies \$12,839 withdrawn against a \$10,000 allowance, which is impossible. The EV formula also refunded the fee to every funded account, including those that never got paid.                                                         | impossible          |
| 13.6% $\times$ \$22,000 naive EV.                                                         | \$8,985 per funded account, above the \$8,000 ceiling.                                                                                                                                                                                   | impossible          |
| 1:1 is the only RR that makes a symmetric walk.                                           | Every fair bracket is a martingale. RR matters only through overshoot.                                                                                                                                                                   | false               |
| Fixed $\pm$ \$4,800 trades at 1:1.                                                        | Overshoots the target and cuts Phase 1 from 50% to 41%.                                                                                                                                                                                  | costly              |
| A constant $\sim$ \$30 cost per trade regardless of size creates a "trap" near the floor. | Costs scale with lot size. With proportional costs there is no trap, and dynamic sizing does not change the pass probability.                                                                                                            | model bug           |
| Effective win rate of 48.5% (spread asymmetry plus mean reversion).                       | Measured 49.7–50.4% for symmetric brackets. The spread asymmetry is the spread cost, so it was counted twice.                                                                                                                            | not in data         |
| Quit Phase 1 after two consecutive full losses.                                           | Throws away live value. On real data, removing it moves the protocol from $-\$70$ to $+\$884$ .                                                                                                                                          | main loss           |
| Kelly implies a \$40M bankroll.                                                           | Units error. About \$4,100 for bold play, \$6,000 for the Part 2 plan.                                                                                                                                                                   | 10,000 $\times$ off |
| RR table shows 1:1.5 as best.                                                             | The table's own maximum was 1:0.5; the differences are simulation noise.                                                                                                                                                                 | noise               |
| Use 1:2 on the funded account for more EV.                                                | Funded value is $\text{split} \times B$ for any RR.                                                                                                                                                                                      | irrelevant          |
| Abandoned accounts free up allocation.                                                    | They remain open and count toward the cap.                                                                                                                                                                                               | false               |
| "Defensibility": vary lots, rotate sessions, add decoy trades, stagger purchases.         | These disguise a pattern the terms prohibit. If discovered, they justify forfeiture. Part 2 follows the rules instead.                                                                                                                   | removed             |
| \$4,600–5,000 per month from four accounts.                                               | Derived from wrong per-attempt maths with a losing protocol. A corrected fast plan inside the risk guidance (Chapter 13) reaches a similar order, about \$2,400 per FTMO slot per month in the zero-edge model, if payouts are honoured. | wrong derivation    |
| Zero-skill play is positive EV if payouts are honoured.                                   | Correct, and by more per attempt than the earlier documents said.                                                                                                                                                                        | correct             |

# What the mathematics cannot tell you

Every number so far assumes the firm pays what it owes. That assumption is the weakest link, and no model can price it.

- **Payouts are discretionary.** Funded accounts are simulated, and "rewards" are paid under terms that let the firm refuse them for practices it considers non-genuine.
- **Conduct rules.** FTMO lists "overleveraging, overexposure, one-sided bets, account rolling" and hedging across accounts as forbidden, and recommends risking 1–1.5% per trade. The bold plan of Chapter 4 matches the prohibited pattern.
- **Firm failure.** About 80–100 prop firms closed in 2024–25. True Forex Funds closed owing about \$1.2 million; The Funded Trader admitted to more than \$2 million in denied payouts; MyForexFunds was shut by a CFTC action in 2023.
- **Rule changes.** Fees, splits and limits change often. Each change moves the numbers in this document.
- **Behaviour.** The maths assumes you follow the plan exactly through long losing runs. Skipping trades, sizing up to "win it back" or quitting live accounts all lower the result.
- **Model limits.** The real-data test covers 2.8 years of one currency pair. A different period could show more or less mean reversion. Costs differ between platforms.

BREAK-EVEN PAYOUT REFUSAL RATE (FTMO 2-STEP, 1% COSTS)

$EV \geq 0$  as long as fewer than about 77% of owed payouts are refused

That looks comfortable, but refusals are not independent coin flips. A refusal usually comes with the account closed and the person barred, which ends all future attempts. The realistic protection is to trade in a way that does not breach the terms at all. That is the purpose of Part 2.

# Every trade resolved on a price path

Version 2 modelled each account with a calendar and the firm's rules, but drew each trade's outcome and duration from distributions measured once on real data. From version 3 on, every trade is opened at a real hour, its stop and target are checked bar by bar against an hourly price path, and the firm's rules (daily loss, floors, minimum days, profitable days, payout dates, caps, refunds) are applied around it. Version 4 adds a lockstep engine: all of one person's accounts run on one price path and one calendar at the same time, so the rule that no two accounts may hold opposite positions is enforced trade by trade.

## 17.1 Two kinds of price path

| Path             | What it is                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Used for                                                                                                   |
|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Synthetic</b> | A random walk with exactly zero edge, the Nasdaq's real hourly volatility, 12 years long, markets closed at weekends. Highs and lows inside each hour are drawn from the exact distribution of a continuous path (a "Brownian bridge"), so stops are monitored as real stop orders are. Eight independent paths are used for the portfolio results. | All headline figures. A zero-skill trader can do no better or worse than this, on average.                 |
| <b>Real</b>      | Hourly Nasdaq-100 bars, 2024–26, with measured spreads and overnight financing.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | A check. One two-year path carries its own trends, so real-path figures scatter around the synthetic ones. |

## 17.2 Checks that the engine is fair

| Check (synthetic path, no costs unless stated)                                 | Theory            | Engine                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|----------------------------|
| Win rate of a 1 : 1 bracket                                                    | 50 . 0%           | 49 . 98%                   |
| Win rate of a 1 : 2 bracket                                                    | 33 . 3%           | 33 . 4%                    |
| Average result of a 1 : 3 bracket, in units of risk                            | 0                 | +0 . 013 ± 0 . 020         |
| FTMO Phase 1 pass rate, one position at a time                                 | 49 . 6%           | 49 . 2%                    |
| FTMO Phase 1 pass rate, four positions at a time (combined target capped)      | 49 . 6%           | 49 . 9%                    |
| The5ers Phase 1 / Phase 2 pass rate with the profitable-days rule (with costs) | < 50% / < 66 . 7% | 46 . 6% / 63 . 3%          |
| Opposite positions between a person's accounts, lockstep engine                | 0                 | 0 in 1,200 simulated years |

## 17.3 Traps found on the way

Each of these made a simulation look better than reality. All are fixed in every figure of version 4, and each is a trap for anyone writing their own test.

1. **Skipping the entry bar.** Checking the stop and target only from the next hour onwards gave a zero-skill 1 : 3 trade a fake +0.14 R.
2. **Checking the price too rarely.** Sampling 12 times an hour misses stop touches in between: a fake +0.11 R.
3. **Overshooting the target with several positions.** Profit beyond a target is wasted pass probability (Chapter 18).
4. **A take-profit equal to the distance left.** The cost turns the last "win" into a loss; the target must be the distance left plus the cost.
5. **Ignoring gaps against the daily limit.** A price gap can push a loss past the stop and through the daily loss limit. Version 4 fails the account when that happens.
6. **Holding where the plan says flat.** The plan is flat at weekends on every account, evaluation included, and futures firms forbid overnight positions. Version 4 enforces both.
7. **Padding "profitable days" with tiny trades.** The5ers counts only days with at least +0.5% profit and forbids constructing them artificially. Version 3 had padded them with tiny trades; that overstated The5ers by about a third. Version 4 uses a daily profit target with full risk on every trade (Section 26.4).
8. **Letting a big win break a best-day rule.** On funded accounts with a consistency rule, the take-profit is now capped so that one day can never exceed the limit.

## 17.4 How the figure for one FTMO account moved

| FTMO 2-Step 100K, zero edge                                     | EV per month per slot | Days per attempt |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|------------------|
| Version 2 account model (1 : 3, funded +\$1,000 then +\$10,000) | \$2,444               | —                |
| Path engine, 1 : 3, funded cycles of +10%                       | \$3,711               | 11.6             |
| Path engine, 1 : 5, funded +\$1,000 first                       | \$3,424               | 15.1             |
| <b>The plan: 1 : 5, funded cycles of +10%</b>                   | <b>\$4,229</b>        | <b>11.8</b>      |
| The plan on the real 2024–26 path                               | \$4,322               | 15.6             |

# Many positions at once

The idea: instead of one trade at a time on one instrument, open several at once (Nasdaq and S&P 500, or many pairs), so the account reaches its target or floor sooner. This chapter works out what that can and cannot do, then tests every variant on price paths.

## 18.1 Three facts

- The pass chance does not change.** A fair game stays fair however many bets run at once, so a phase still passes with probability  $B \div (A + B)$ . That holds only if profit beyond the target is not wasted (18.3).
- Correlated positions in the same direction are one bigger bet.** Two positions risking  $L_1$  and  $L_2$  on instruments with correlation  $\rho$  carry the risk of a single position of  $\sqrt{(L_1^2 + L_2^2 + 2\rho L_1 L_2)}$ . Nasdaq and S&P 500 move together with  $\rho \approx 0.9$ , so 1.5% on each is about 2.9% on one idea. That is twice FTMO's 1–1.5% guidance on what is really one trade, and FundedNext lists "concentrated directional exposure" and several trades in the same direction as prohibited one-sided betting. It also costs more than a single Nasdaq position of the same size, because the S&P CFD costs about twice as much per unit of movement (Chapter 9).
- Independent positions add speed, but the calendar does not move.** Two independent positions double the rate at which the balance moves, so trading time halves. But an attempt also contains minimum trading days, account reviews and payout dates, which no amount of trading shortens.

## 18.2 Results

| Set-up (FTMO 2-Step 100K)                       | Open risk                   | EV per month | vs one position | Days per attempt | Pass both phases |
|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|------------------|
| Nasdaq alone, 1.5%                              | one position                | \$3,180      | +0%             | 15.1             | 29%              |
| Nasdaq + S&P 500, same direction, 0.75% each    | total 1.5%                  | \$2,301      | -28%            | 15.2             | 26%              |
| Nasdaq + S&P 500, same direction, 1.5% each     | $\approx 2.9\%$ on one idea | \$3,570      | +12%            | 13.3             | 28%              |
| Nasdaq alone, 3% (reference, beyond guidance)   | one position                | \$3,993      | +26%            | 12.6             | 30%              |
| Nasdaq + gold, 1.5% each, at most 1.5% open     | one at a time               | \$3,067      | -4%             | 15.4             | 29%              |
| Nasdaq + gold, 1.5% each                        | up to 3% open               | \$2,681      | -16%            | 13.9             | 27%              |
| Nasdaq + gold + yen + euro, 1.5% each           | up to 4.5% open             | \$2,727      | -14%            | 15.5             | 27%              |
| Two independent Nasdaq-like markets (imaginary) | up to 3% open               | \$3,220      | +1%             | 14.7             | 29%              |

| Set-up (FTMO 2-Step 100K)                        | Open risk     | EV per month | vs one position | Days per attempt | Pass both phases |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------|--------------|-----------------|------------------|------------------|
| Four independent Nasdaq-like markets (imaginary) | up to 6% open | \$3,315      | +4%             | 13.6             | 29%              |
| Nasdaq alone, no costs at all                    | one position  | \$4,129      | +30%            | 16.9             | 32%              |
| Four independent markets, no costs at all        | up to 6% open | \$4,614      | +45%            | 16.6             | 34%              |

Synthetic zero-edge paths, 6,000 attempts per row, combined target capped. These runs used the version 2 settings (1 : 3, funded +\$1,000 first), so compare rows with each other rather than with later chapters. Noise is about ±\$330 per month per row.

Read the table in three groups.

- **Same total risk, split across correlated instruments** (Nasdaq + S&P at 0.75% each): 28% worse than one Nasdaq position at 1.5%. The risk is the same, so there is no speed gain, and the spread is paid twice.
- **Twice the risk, via a correlated second position** (1.5% each): 12% better than one 1.5% position, but 11% worse than simply trading one Nasdaq position at 3%. Stacking is the expensive way to take a bigger bet, and either way the bet exceeds the guidance.
- **Independent instruments** (gold, yen, euro next to the Nasdaq): worse, because every other instrument costs two to three times more per unit of movement. Even an imaginary second Nasdaq with independent prices and identical costs adds only 1–4%, within the noise, because the calendar dominates.

## 18.3 The overshoot trap

With several positions open, the target can be crossed by more than one of them. Profit beyond the target is pass probability thrown away: by optional stopping,  $P(\text{pass}) = (B + \text{overshoot at the floor}) \div (A + B + \text{overshoot at the target} + \text{overshoot at the floor})$ . Four uncapped positions (no costs) passed Phase 1 only 43% of the time, against the theoretical 49.6%, because the average balance at a pass was +\$13,665 rather than +\$10,000. Capping the *combined* target of all open positions at the distance left restored 49.9%.

### VERDICT

One position at a time, on the cheapest instrument per unit of movement, at the top of the firm's guidance. More positions help only if a second instrument is as cheap as the Nasdaq and independent of it, and none is. The way to grow income is more accounts, not more positions per account (Chapter 21).

# Account size, account type and the settings that matter

## 19.1 50K, 100K or 200K

| Account          | Fee     | Fee ÷ size | EV per month | per \$100K of allowance |
|------------------|---------|------------|--------------|-------------------------|
| FTMO 2-Step 50K  | \$404   | 0.81%      | \$1,853      | \$3,707                 |
| FTMO 2-Step 100K | \$632   | 0.63%      | \$4,044      | \$4,044                 |
| FTMO 2-Step 200K | \$1,264 | 0.63%      | \$8,478      | \$4,239                 |
| FTMO 1-Step 100K | \$584   | 0.58%      | \$3,259      | \$3,259                 |
| FTMO 1-Step 200K | \$1,168 | 0.58%      | \$6,807      | \$3,404                 |

1 : 5, funded cycles of +10% of the account, 10,000 synthetic attempts each; noise about ±8% per row.

The value of an account is proportional to its loss allowance, and so is everything else, including the risk per trade. What differs is the fee per dollar of allowance: FTMO charges about 0.63% of the account size for 100K and 200K, but 0.81% for 50K. So, per dollar of the \$400,000 cap, two 200K accounts and four 100K accounts are worth about the same, and 50K accounts less. Four 100K accounts can be started at different times; two 200K accounts mean fewer logins and orders.

## 19.2 1-Step or 2-Step

FTMO's 1-Step (one 10% target, 90% split, but a 3% daily limit, an end-of-day trailing floor and a 50% best-day rule) gives \$3,400 per month per slot, against \$4,200 for the 2-Step. The best-day rule forces profits to be spread over several days, and the trailing floor shrinks the allowance after good days. The 2-Step is better for this plan.

## 19.3 The settings, one at a time

FTMO 2-Step 100K, synthetic paths, zero edge, 10,000 attempts per row. Each row changes one setting from the plan: stop 0.75 hourly moves, 1 : 5, risk 1.5%, funded cycles of +10%.

| Setting (all else as in the plan)                          | EV per month   | Days per attempt | Pass both phases |
|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|------------------|------------------|
| <b>The plan (stop 0.75, 1 : 5, risk 1.5%, +10% cycles)</b> | <b>\$4,044</b> | <b>11.6</b>      | <b>30%</b>       |
| ... on the real 2024–26 path                               | \$4,178        | 15.5             | 33%              |
| Risk 1% per trade                                          | \$3,054        | 14.3             | 28%              |
| Risk 2% per trade (beyond FTMO's guidance)                 | \$4,500        | 10.9             | 30%              |
| Risk 3% per trade (beyond FTMO's guidance)                 | \$4,986        | 10.0             | 31%              |
| Stop 0.5 hourly moves                                      | \$4,257        | 10.5             | 30%              |
| Stop 1 hourly moves                                        | \$3,765        | 13.7             | 31%              |

| Setting (all else as in the plan)             | EV per month | Days per attempt | Pass both phases |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------|------------------|------------------|
| Stop 1.5 hourly moves                         | \$2,887      | 20.0             | 32%              |
| Stop 3 hourly moves                           | \$983        | 53.7             | 32%              |
| Reward : risk 1 : 1                           | \$1,849      | 11.5             | 24%              |
| Reward : risk 1 : 2                           | \$3,050      | 11.5             | 27%              |
| Reward : risk 1 : 3                           | \$3,711      | 11.6             | 29%              |
| Reward : risk 1 : 4                           | \$3,876      | 11.6             | 30%              |
| Reward : risk 1 : 6                           | \$4,369      | 12.0             | 31%              |
| Reward : risk 1 : 8                           | \$4,561      | 12.3             | 31%              |
| Reward : risk 1 : 10                          | \$4,217      | 12.1             | 31%              |
| Reward : risk 1 : 3, real path                | \$3,611      | 15.4             | 31%              |
| Reward : risk 1 : 4, real path                | \$4,147      | 15.8             | 33%              |
| Reward : risk 1 : 6, real path                | \$3,879      | 14.7             | 32%              |
| Reward : risk 1 : 8, real path                | \$3,994      | 15.0             | 33%              |
| Funded: first cycle +\$1,000, then +\$10,000  | \$3,424      | 15.1             | 30%              |
| Funded: first cycle +\$3,000, then +\$10,000  | \$3,789      | 14.2             | 31%              |
| Funded: first cycle +\$5,000, then +\$10,000  | \$3,759      | 12.9             | 30%              |
| Funded: first cycle +\$10,000, then +\$20,000 | \$4,345      | 11.0             | 29%              |

10,000 attempts per row (seed 31); noise about  $\pm \$300$  per month. The plan's final figure from 24,000 attempts with other seeds is \$4,229 (Chapter 20).

## 19.4 Why 1 : 5

Trades per phase fall in proportion to the reward-to-risk ratio  $k$  ( $A \times B \div k L^2$ ), and so does the spread paid. Time per trade rises in proportion to  $k$ , so the time per phase barely changes. The gain flattens between 1 : 5 and 1 : 8 because near a target most trades are capped at the distance left anyway; on the real 2024–26 path the best was 1 : 4 to 1 : 5. The plan uses 1 : 5.

The price of 1 : 5 is psychological. Only about one trade in six wins. A run of ten losses in a row has a probability of about  $(5/6)^{10} \approx 16\%$  at any given point and will happen many times a year. Nothing is wrong when it does.

## 19.5 Funded accounts: run cycles of the full allowance

With zero edge, the total paid out by a funded account averages the split times its loss allowance, whatever the payout policy (Chapter 5). What the policy changes is time. A small first target (+\$1,000) reaches the first payout safely, but then the account sits idle waiting for the date. Aiming for +10% (+12% on a 12% allowance) in every cycle finishes accounts sooner and recycles the slot into a new attempt. At FTMO: \$4,044 per month with +10% cycles against \$3,424 with +\$1,000 first.

## 19.6 If your costs are higher

| Programme                    | Measured costs | × 1.5          | × 2            | × 3            |
|------------------------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|----------------|
| FTMO 2-Step                  | \$4,185        | \$3,872 (-7%)  | \$3,673 (-12%) | \$3,107 (-26%) |
| FundingPips 2-Step Flex, 95% | \$6,154        | \$5,490 (-11%) | \$4,981 (-19%) | \$4,288 (-30%) |
| Blue Guardian 2-Step         | \$4,166        | \$4,014 (-4%)  | \$3,565 (-14%) | \$3,047 (-27%) |

EV per month per slot, 8,000 synthetic attempts per cell; the cost multiplier applies to spread, commission and slippage.

The plan tolerates moderate cost differences between firms: half again the measured Nasdaq cost loses 4–11% of the value, double the cost 12–19%. Measure each firm's spread before you start (Section 25.3).

# Every firm, compared on the same paths

## VERSION 5 NOTE

Six firms in this chapter (Alpha Capital, BrightFunded, Blue Guardian, FunderPro, Maven, GFT) have since had their TrustPilot rating withheld for fake reviews. Part 3 (Chapters 33–35) re-ranks the firms, adds Fintokey and Hola Prime, and revises the per-person plan.

Each programme was run with the plan of Part 2 (Nasdaq, stop 0.75 hourly moves, 1 : 5, risk 1.5% of the account; for futures, the best of a grid), 24,000 attempts on synthetic paths and 8,000 on the real path. Rules and prices were checked in October 2026 (Appendix D).

## 20.1 CFD programmes (100K accounts)

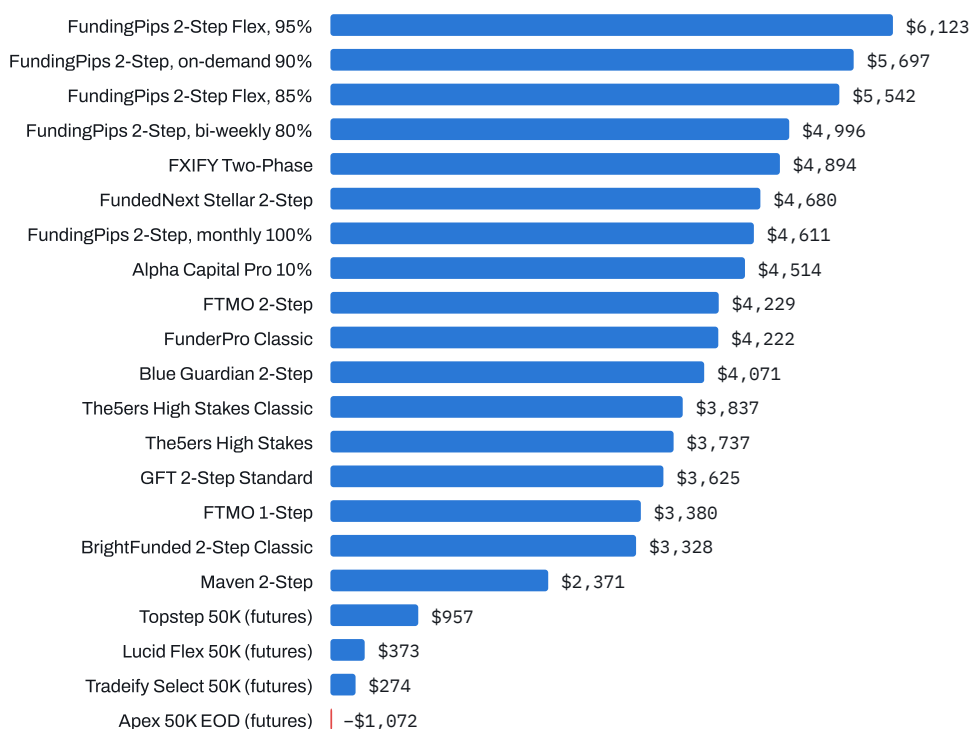


Figure 20.1 · EV per month per slot, the plan, synthetic zero-edge paths (CFD slots are 100K, futures 50K).

| Programme (100K)                                                                                       | Fee   | Pass | Paid per funded acct | Funded days | EV per attempt | Days per attempt | EV / month     | Real path | 1st payout (day) |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|------|----------------------|-------------|----------------|------------------|----------------|-----------|------------------|
| <b>FundingPips 2-Step Flex, 95%</b><br>10/6%, 4% daily, 12% static, 3 profitable days per payout cycle | \$499 | 33%  | \$10,200             | 21          | \$2,863        | 14.2             | <b>\$6,123</b> | \$6,385   | 23               |
| <b>FundingPips 2-Step, on-demand 90%</b><br>8/5%, payout any time at ≥ 2%, no day > 35%                | \$529 | 34%  | \$7,400              | 13          | \$1,994        | 10.7             | <b>\$5,697</b> | \$5,002   | 16               |

| Programme (100K)                                                                                | Fee   | Pass | Paid per funded acct | Funded days | EV per attempt | Days per attempt | EV / month     | Real path | 1st payout (day) |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|------|----------------------|-------------|----------------|------------------|----------------|-----------|------------------|
| <b>FundingPips 2-Step Flex, 85%</b><br>10/6%, 4% daily, 12% static                              | \$499 | 33%  | \$9,000              | 19          | \$2,472        | 13.6             | <b>\$5,542</b> | \$5,925   | 23               |
| <b>FundingPips 2-Step, bi-weekly 80%</b><br>8/5%, refund with 4th payout                        | \$529 | 34%  | \$7,200              | 16          | \$1,916        | 11.7             | <b>\$4,996</b> | \$5,173   | 24               |
| <b>FXIFY Two-Phase</b><br>10/5%, refund with 1st payout                                         | \$480 | 30%  | \$7,000              | 16          | \$1,634        | 10.2             | <b>\$4,894</b> | \$4,859   | 22               |
| <b>FundedNext Stellar 2-Step</b><br>8/5%, 5 days, +15% of challenge profit, first payout day 21 | \$550 | 33%  | \$8,200              | 19          | \$2,170        | 14.1             | <b>\$4,680</b> | \$5,038   | 35               |
| <b>FundingPips 2-Step, monthly 100%</b><br>8/5%, 100% split, monthly                            | \$529 | 34%  | \$9,000              | 31          | \$2,485        | 16.4             | <b>\$4,611</b> | \$4,562   | 40               |
| <b>Alpha Capital Pro 10%</b><br>10/5%, 3 days, no refund assumed                                | \$497 | 30%  | \$7,200              | 16          | \$1,638        | 11.0             | <b>\$4,514</b> | \$4,464   | 24               |
| <b>FTMO 2-Step</b><br>10/5%, 4 days per phase, payouts every 14 days                            | \$632 | 30%  | \$7,500              | 16          | \$1,644        | 11.8             | <b>\$4,229</b> | \$4,322   | 26               |
| <b>FunderPro Classic</b><br>10/8%, refund with 1st payout                                       | \$431 | 25%  | \$7,200              | 16          | \$1,339        | 9.7              | <b>\$4,222</b> | \$4,308   | 23               |
| <b>Blue Guardian 2-Step</b><br>8/4%, 4% daily, 8% max, 85%                                      | \$497 | 31%  | \$5,800              | 13          | \$1,285        | 9.6              | <b>\$4,071</b> | \$4,462   | 24               |
| <b>The5ers High Stakes Classic</b><br>8/5%, 3 profitable days per phase, \$545                  | \$545 | 33%  | \$7,200              | 16          | \$1,807        | 14.3             | <b>\$3,837</b> | \$4,258   | 28               |
| <b>The5ers High Stakes</b><br>10/5%, 3 profitable days per phase                                | \$491 | 30%  | \$7,300              | 17          | \$1,698        | 13.8             | <b>\$3,737</b> | \$3,910   | 28               |
| <b>GFT 2-Step Standard</b><br>10/5%, funded ≤ \$3,000/day, first 2 payouts ≤ 6%                 | \$524 | 30%  | \$6,800              | 25          | \$1,524        | 12.8             | <b>\$3,625</b> | \$3,558   | 22               |
| <b>FTMO 1-Step</b><br>10%, 3% daily, trailing floor, best day ≤ 50%                             | \$584 | 34%  | \$6,400              | 17          | \$1,590        | 14.3             | <b>\$3,380</b> | \$3,007   | 24               |
| <b>BrightFunded 2-Step Classic</b><br>10/5%, 5 days, first payout day 30                        | \$580 | 30%  | \$7,200              | 23          | \$1,590        | 14.5             | <b>\$3,328</b> | \$3,569   | 44               |
| <b>Maven 2-Step</b><br>8/5%, 4% daily, 8% max, 3 profitable days, \$10K/30 days payout cap      | \$440 | 27%  | \$5,500              | 18          | \$1,049        | 13.5             | <b>\$2,371</b> | \$2,587   | 28               |

Most CFD programmes fall between \$3,500 and \$5,300 per month per slot, with about ±\$170 of simulation noise each; the real path agrees within its noise. The best product found is **FundingPips 2-Step Flex with the 95% split**: a 12% static loss allowance instead of 10%, for a lower fee, and 95% of profits in exchange for three profitable days (at least +0.5%) in each two-week payout cycle. What

separates the rest is mostly how long each step takes and side rules: GFT caps funded profit at \$3,000 a day, BrightFunded pays first after 30 days, FundedNext pays 15% of challenge profits with the first payout but waits 21 days for it, Maven caps payouts at \$10,000 per 30 days per person.

## 20.2 Trading gold instead of the Nasdaq

| Firm (one account)        | Nasdaq  | Gold    | change | EURUSD  | change |
|---------------------------|---------|---------|--------|---------|--------|
| FundedNext Stellar 2-Step | \$4,681 | \$4,316 | -8%    | \$3,328 | -29%   |
| FunderPro Classic         | \$4,152 | \$3,803 | -8%    | \$2,339 | -44%   |
| GFT 2-Step Standard       | \$3,586 | \$3,300 | -8%    | \$2,163 | -40%   |

EV per month per slot, 12,000 synthetic attempts each, stop 0.75 hourly moves of the market traded (EURUSD: 1.0), 1 : 5.

Where a firm's rules make copied or duplicated trades risky (Chapter 23), its one account can trade gold instead, independently of the Nasdaq accounts. Gold costs about 8% of the value; EURUSD would cost about 40%.

## 20.3 Futures firms (50K accounts, micro Nasdaq futures)

| Programme (50K)                                                    | Fee                | Pass | Paid per funded acct | Funded days | EV per attempt | Days per attempt | EV / month          | Real path |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|------|----------------------|-------------|----------------|------------------|---------------------|-----------|
| <b>Topstep 50K</b><br>risk \$950, 1 : 5, flat by 20:00 UTC         | \$49/month + \$149 | 24%  | \$808                | 7           | \$107          | 3.4              | <b>\$957</b> ±225   | \$1,977   |
| <b>Tradeify Select 50K</b><br>risk \$950, 1 : 5, flat by 20:00 UTC | \$165              | 21%  | \$932                | 6           | \$30           | 3.3              | <b>\$274</b> ±276   | \$670     |
| <b>Lucid Flex 50K</b><br>risk \$800, 1 : 5, flat by 20:00 UTC      | \$146              | 24%  | \$811                | 7           | \$46           | 3.7              | <b>\$373</b> ±220   | \$1,200   |
| <b>Apex 50K EOD</b><br>risk \$950, 1 : 2, flat by 20:00 UTC        | \$490              | 37%  | \$614                | 14          | -\$264         | 7.5              | <b>-\$1,072</b> ±95 | -\$1,312  |

Futures programmes are much weaker for this plan. Their loss allowance is small (\$2,000 on 50K, against \$10,000 on a 100K CFD account), it trails the balance, it locks just above the starting balance, and payouts need five qualifying days and are capped at about half the profit. Topstep is the only one clearly positive, and only just; running it at full speed means dozens of failed Combines a month (Chapter 21). Apex at its \$490 list price loses money: at \$147 (a 70% discount) it would be \$79 per attempt, about \$323 per month; at \$98 (a 80% discount) it would be \$128 per attempt, about \$522 per month. The plan leaves futures out.

## 20.4 Crypto programmes

Unchanged from Chapter 9: 24/7 trading does not compensate for crypto's cost per unit of movement, which is 5–10 times the Nasdaq's.

# The maximum per person

## VERSION 5 NOTE

Six firms in this chapter (Alpha Capital, BrightFunded, Blue Guardian, FunderPro, Maven, GFT) have since had their TrustPilot rating withheld for fake reviews. Part 3 (Chapters 33–35) re-ranks the firms, adds Fintokey and Hola Prime, and revises the per-person plan.

Every firm limits how much it allocates to one person, and several limit how many of their accounts may carry the same trades. Within those limits the plan can run in parallel at many firms. This chapter adds it up with the lockstep engine: all accounts on one price path, one calendar, one shared direction.

## 21.1 Caps and copying rules

| Firm                 | Allocation cap                                                                    | Copying the same trades on several of your accounts | Max. accounts used |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>FTMO</b>          | \$400,000 per trader or strategy, all accounts (treated as including evaluations) | allowed within the cap                              | 4                  |
| <b>FundingPips</b>   | \$400,000 across evaluation, funded and Prime accounts                            | own FundingPips accounts; no copier services        | 4                  |
| <b>Alpha Capital</b> | \$400,000 per household; \$300,000 per strategy                                   | allowed from own accounts with proof                | 3                  |
| <b>BrightFunded</b>  | \$400,000 funded; evaluations unlimited                                           | allowed between own accounts at any firm            | 4                  |
| <b>Blue Guardian</b> | \$400,000; evaluations up to \$200,000 each                                       | own accounts only                                   | 4                  |
| <b>The5ers</b>       | one 100K High Stakes account (plus smaller ones)                                  | allowed                                             | 1                  |
| <b>FXIFY</b>         | reported \$805,000 (one account per size); confirm                                | only after approval; herd trading prohibited        | 1                  |
| <b>GFT</b>           | \$400,000 funded                                                                  | no duplicated trades between GFT accounts           | 1                  |
| <b>FunderPro</b>     | \$200,000                                                                         | no replicating across FunderPro accounts            | 1                  |
| <b>Maven</b>         | \$200,000; payouts ≤ \$10,000 per 30 days                                         | own 2-Step accounts                                 | 1                  |
| <b>FundedNext</b>    | \$300,000 funded; evaluations unlimited                                           | never involving a funded account                    | 1 (gold)           |

## 21.2 Four ways to run it

| Version                         | Steady month    | First-year average | Ahead after 1 / 3 / 12 months | Cash low: typical / bad case (1 in 20) | Most failed accounts at one firm per month |
|---------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| One account per firm (11)       | <b>\$49,100</b> | <b>\$43,800</b>    | <b>31% / 90% / 100%</b>       | <b>-\$22K / -\$47K</b>                 | <b>3</b>                                   |
| Two per firm where allowed (16) | <b>\$71,800</b> | \$64,000           | 32% / 88% / 100%              | -\$32K / -\$74K                        | 6                                          |

| Version                             | Steady month     | First-year average | Ahead after 1 / 3 / 12 months | Cash low: typical / bad case (1 in 20) | Most failed accounts at one firm per month |
|-------------------------------------|------------------|--------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Full caps (25)                      | <b>\$113,600</b> | \$101,000          | 30% / 84% / 100%              | -\$52K / -\$126K                       | 12                                         |
| Full caps, firms added monthly (25) | <b>\$97,600</b>  | \$82,400           | 21% / 70% / 100%              | -\$21K / -\$91K                        | 10                                         |
| FTMO only (4)                       | <b>\$17,400</b>  | \$15,700           | 21% / 79% / 95%               | -\$13K / -\$53K                        | 10                                         |

Lockstep engine: 200 simulated years per version on 8 independent zero-edge price paths; shared direction enforced; no opposite positions occurred.

"Steady month" is the average month once every slot is running (months 3–12); "first year" averages all twelve months including the slow start. "Cash low" is the lowest point of cumulative cash (fees paid minus payouts received). All figures assume zero skill and that every payout is honoured. The real 2024–26 path, run the same way, gave \$54,900 (one per firm) and \$126,200 (full caps) per steady month, with the gold account mapped to the Nasdaq because the real gold series is not aligned with it.

## 21.3 Why accounts move together, and what it costs

No two of your accounts may hold opposite positions at the same time; at most firms that is hedging, and FTMO also forbids it across firms. So every Nasdaq account trades the same direction at the same time, and their results move together: in a bad week every account loses at once, and funded accounts tend to pass and fail in batches. That is why the cash low points above are large and why the first months are usually negative. Expected value is unaffected by moving together; only the spread of outcomes is.

## 21.4 Failed accounts per firm

A zero-skill plan fails most of its accounts quickly, and every failed evaluation is replaced at once. FundedNext lists "multiple account breaches quickly" and "losses exceeding gains" among the signs of the gambling behaviour it prohibits, and FTMO monitors "account rolling". Running four accounts at one firm means about ten failed accounts a month at that firm:

| Firm                          | One account per firm | Full caps |
|-------------------------------|----------------------|-----------|
| Blue Guardian 2-Step          | 3.0                  | 12.0      |
| FTMO 2-Step                   | 2.4                  | 9.7       |
| FundingPips 2-Step Flex (95%) | 2.1                  | 8.6       |
| BrightFunded 2-Step Classic   | 2.1                  | 8.4       |
| Alpha Capital Pro 10%         | 2.6                  | 7.9       |
| FunderPro Classic             | 2.9                  | 2.9       |
| FXIFY Two-Phase               | 2.9                  | 2.9       |
| Maven 2-Step                  | 2.2                  | 2.3       |

| Firm                      | One account per firm | Full caps |
|---------------------------|----------------------|-----------|
| FundedNext Stellar 2-Step | 2.3                  | 2.3       |
| GFT 2-Step Standard       | 2.2                  | 2.2       |
| The5ers High Stakes       | 2.2                  | 2.1       |

Failed evaluations plus lost funded accounts, per firm per month, lockstep engine.

One account per firm keeps every firm at about two failed accounts a month, which is what any losing trader produces. That is why Part 2 recommends one account per firm as the default and treats more as a deliberate choice.

### READ THIS BEFORE THE TOTALS

These are expected values under three assumptions: zero skill, every firm pays every payout, and no firm changes its rules. Payouts are discretionary. Running the same short, systematic trades on many accounts at eleven firms is exactly what risk teams review. One refusal usually closes the account and bars the person. Several prop firms have failed or stopped paying since 2023. The totals are an upper limit of what the contracts are worth, not a forecast of income.

## 21.5 Starting firm by firm

Opening everything on day one maximises the first year but needs the most cash. Adding firms month by month, from payouts already received, lowers the cash low point sharply:

| Full caps                                                                                                                                                       | First-year average | Ahead after 1 / 3 / 6 months | Cash low: typical / bad case |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|
| All 25 accounts on day one                                                                                                                                      | \$101,000          | 30% / 84% / 98%              | -\$52K / -\$126K             |
| Firms added month by month (FTMO; then FundingPips and The5ers; then FundedNext and Alpha; then BrightFunded, Blue Guardian, FunderPro; then FXIFY, GFT, Maven) | \$82,400           | 21% / 70% / 96%              | -\$21K / -\$91K              |

## 21.6 If evaluations were not capped

FundedNext and BrightFunded cap funded accounts but not evaluations. Extra evaluations could in principle keep every funded slot full; a FundedNext funded slot is then worth about \$10,400 per month instead of about \$4,700. In practice the extra evaluations would move together (same direction), pass in batches that cannot all be funded, and multiply failed accounts. The plan does not use this.

## Direction rules, and what one price history can tell you

The plan assumes no skill, so the direction of each trade does not affect expected value as long as the rule is not systematically wrong. Version 2 used a random choice. The plan now uses a written mechanical rule instead (Section 26.3): a risk team can recognise it as a trading plan, while FTMO lists "trading without a plan" under the gambling it monitors. Four rules on the real 2024–26 Nasdaq path:

| Rule (FTMO 2-Step, 1 : 3, real 2024–26 path) | EV per attempt (two runs) | EV per month (two runs) | Pass both |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------|-----------|
| Random direction (version 2)                 | \$1,802 / \$1,928         | \$3,587 / \$3,755       | 30%       |
| Trend, 20 hours                              | \$885 / \$869             | \$2,074 / \$2,024       | 30%       |
| Trend, 5 hours                               | \$2,733 / \$2,801         | \$4,613 / \$4,740       | 35–36%    |
| Reversal, 5 hours                            | \$1,064 / \$1,110         | \$2,327 / \$2,427       | 25%       |

The spread is large: from half to one and a half times the random baseline. To see whether any of it is real, the 5-hour trend rule and the random rule were run on eight independent synthetic paths, where by construction no rule can have an edge:

| Independent zero-edge path | Random         | Trend, 5 hours | Difference          |
|----------------------------|----------------|----------------|---------------------|
| Path 1                     | \$3,955        | \$5,239        | +\$1,284            |
| Path 2                     | \$3,989        | \$3,739        | –\$250              |
| Path 3                     | \$4,610        | \$4,208        | –\$402              |
| Path 4                     | \$4,303        | \$3,609        | –\$694              |
| Path 5                     | \$4,188        | \$4,949        | +\$761              |
| Path 6                     | \$3,999        | \$4,981        | +\$982              |
| Path 7                     | \$4,239        | \$5,089        | +\$850              |
| Path 8                     | \$4,019        | \$3,729        | –\$290              |
| <b>Average</b>             | <b>\$4,163</b> | <b>\$4,443</b> | <b>+\$280 ± 529</b> |

FTMO 2-Step, the plan, 4,000 attempts per cell; EV per month per slot.

The difference averages  $+\$280 \pm 529$  per month, indistinguishable from zero, while individual paths swing from  $-\$694$  to  $+\$1,284$ . A deterministic rule ties results more tightly to whatever the market happens to do, without raising the expected value. One price history can make any rule look good or bad.

#### **WHAT TO DO WITH THIS**

Pick one simple rule, write it down, apply it identically on every account, and plan on the zero-edge figures. If after several hundred trades your rule's full-size win rate at 1 : 5 is clearly above 1 in 6 after costs, that is the first evidence of an edge; until then there is none.

# Rule audit: every firm, every rule that touches the plan

Each firm's published prohibited practices and account rules were checked against the plan of Part 2 (October 2026). "Plan" says how the plan meets the rule; a mark of "check" means the rule could not be confirmed from a reliable source and should be confirmed with the firm in writing before buying.

| Firm                    | Rules that touch the plan                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | How the plan meets them                                                                                                                                        | Status                                     |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| <b>FTMO</b>             | Risk 1–1.5% recommended; gambling (no plan, all-in) monitored; account rolling forbidden; \$400,000 per strategy; no opposite positions across accounts or providers; funded Standard: no weekend holding, $\pm 2$ min news; gap trading forbidden | 1.5% with stop; written rules; every account traded identically (none sacrificed); $4 \times 100K$ ; shared direction; flat at weekends and 10 min before news | ok                                         |
| <b>FundingPips Flex</b> | Risk per trade idea 2% on funded (Master) accounts; no opposite account trading; no weekend holding on Master; $\pm 5$ min restricted news; copying only between own FundingPips accounts; 95% split needs 3 profitable days per cycle             | 1.5%; shared direction; flat at weekends and before news; one own program per account; daily profit target until 3 days of +0.5%                               | ok                                         |
| <b>Alpha Capital</b>    | Never risk or lose 2% or more in one trade or group closed together; no all-or-nothing (large lot and length swings); group trading forbidden; \$300,000 per strategy                                                                              | 1.5%, one position; constant size; own accounts only; 3 accounts                                                                                               | ok                                         |
| <b>BrightFunded</b>     | Trades at least 60 seconds; no gap trading around news; no over-exposure; funded $\pm 5$ min news; copying between own accounts allowed                                                                                                            | trades last hours; flat before news; one position                                                                                                              | ok                                         |
| <b>Blue Guardian</b>    | Funded: all trades closed at $-2\%$ open loss (first time split cut to 50%, second time account closed); no 3–4% risk without stop; copying own accounts only                                                                                      | 1.5% with stop: open loss stays below 2% unless a gap                                                                                                          | ok, watch gaps                             |
| <b>The5ers</b>          | Profitable days must not be constructed artificially; no abrupt size changes or over-exposure; no new orders $\pm 2$ min of high-impact news; programs need written approval                                                                       | daily profit target with full risk; constant size; news window wider than required; trade by hand or get approval                                              | check the daily profit target with The5ers |
| <b>FXIFY</b>            | Herd trading and collusion forbidden; copying own accounts only after approval; gambling forbidden                                                                                                                                                 | one account                                                                                                                                                    | ok                                         |
| <b>GFT</b>              | No duplicated trades between GFT accounts; no third-party or marketed strategy; no martingale; no all-or-nothing                                                                                                                                   | one account; own rules; size never increases after a loss                                                                                                      | ok, if the plan stays private              |
| <b>FunderPro</b>        | Risk per trade at most 2%; no replicating trades across accounts; no copying from accounts you do not own                                                                                                                                          | 1.5%; one account                                                                                                                                              | ok                                         |
| <b>Maven</b>            | 3 profitable days of +0.5% per phase; after \$5,000 paid, no day above 50% of profit; payouts at most \$10,000 per 30 days                                                                                                                         | daily profit target; capped take-profit; one account                                                                                                           | ok                                         |
| <b>FundedNext</b>       | No copying when a funded account is involved; one-sided betting, account rolling and gambling (including many quick breaches) prohibited; trades shorter than 30 s, hyperactivity                                                                  | one account, on gold, independent of the others; one position                                                                                                  | ok, quick breaches unavoidable             |

## 23.1 What could still close an account

- **Discretion.** Every firm reserves the right to refuse payouts and close accounts for behaviour it judges to be gambling or not like real trading. A zero-skill plan has losses roughly equal to gains and many quick failures, which are listed signs at FundedNext. Following every written rule lowers this risk; it cannot remove it.
- **Rule changes.** Several rules above changed during 2026 (FundingPips risk per trade, weekend rules; Apex's whole model). Re-read the terms before every purchase.
- **Firm failure.** Payouts depend on the firm staying solvent and willing to pay.

### DO NOT SHARE OR SELL THIS PLAN

If several people trade the same written rules, their accounts produce the same trades at the same moments. FTMO calls that group or copy trading, FundedNext monitors synchronized entries across traders, Alpha Capital calls it group trading, FXIFY prohibits herd trading, and GFT closes accounts that use "any third-party strategy ... or one marketed to pass assessment accounts". A plan like this works, in so far as it works at all, only for one person trading it privately. Selling it would also mean selling expectations that depend on discretionary payouts and zero-edge maths, not on any trading skill.

## PART 2

# Execution

The plan that maximised expected value per month per person in Part 1, written step by step and checked against every firm's published rules (Chapter 23). It uses one position at a time on the Nasdaq, grows by adding firms rather than risk, and by default runs one account per firm.

# The plan on one page

## VERSION 5 NOTE

Six firms in this chapter (Alpha Capital, BrightFunded, Blue Guardian, FunderPro, Maven, GFT) have since had their TrustPilot rating withheld for fake reviews. Part 3 (Chapters 33–35) re-ranks the firms, adds Fintokeyi and Hola Prime, and revises the per-person plan.

## READ THIS FIRST

- All figures assume zero skill and that every firm pays every payout. Payouts are discretionary; one refusal usually ends that firm.
- The trades have no edge. About seven attempts in ten lose their whole fee. With eleven firms, the chance of being ahead is about 51% after six weeks and 89% after thirteen (Chapter 30).
- For your use only: shared, the same trades on many people's accounts become prohibited group trading (Chapter 23).

## 24.1 Accounts (default: one per firm)

| Firm and programme (100K)          | Market                     | Funded cycle target                         |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| FTMO 2-Step                        | Nasdaq                     | +10%                                        |
| FundingPips 2-Step Flex, 95% split | Nasdaq                     | +12%, with 3 profitable days per cycle      |
| Alpha Capital Pro 10%              | Nasdaq                     | +10%                                        |
| BrightFunded 2-Step Classic        | Nasdaq                     | +10%                                        |
| Blue Guardian 2-Step               | Nasdaq                     | +10% (never let open loss reach 2%)         |
| The5ers High Stakes                | Nasdaq                     | +10%                                        |
| FXIFY Two-Phase                    | Nasdaq                     | +10%                                        |
| GFT 2-Step Standard                | Nasdaq                     | +7% first, then +10%; \$3,000 a day at most |
| FunderPro Classic                  | Nasdaq                     | +10%                                        |
| Maven 2-Step                       | Nasdaq                     | +8%                                         |
| FundedNext Stellar 2-Step          | Gold, traded independently | +10%                                        |

Optional, after several months with every payout honoured: a second account at FTMO, FundingPips, Alpha Capital, BrightFunded and Blue Guardian (16 accounts), or their full caps (25 accounts). Each step raises expected value and also the failed accounts per firm (Chapter 21).

## 24.2 Every trade

1. **One position at a time** per account; the next one as soon as the last closes.

2. **Window:** Monday to Friday, 01:00–20:00 UTC. No new trade after 19:00 UTC Friday; be flat by 20:30 UTC Friday on every account.
3. **Direction:** the shared rule (26.3). Nasdaq accounts never oppose each other; the gold account follows its own rule.
4. **Risk** = the smallest of 1.5% of the account size, (room above the floor – 0.1%), and (today's loss room – 0.2%).
5. **Stop** =  $0.75 \times$  the hourly move, attached on entry, never moved.
6. **Target** =  $5 \times$  the stop distance, capped at the distance left to the phase or cycle target plus this trade's cost, and at any daily profit target or cap (26.4).
7. **News:** no new trade from 15 minutes before to 5 minutes after a high-impact US release (gold: also US releases). On funded accounts, be flat 10 minutes before.

## 24.3 Every account

- Never abandon a live account (Section 3.3). At a phase target, stop; fill missing minimum days with one small trade a day where the firm counts trading days (FTMO, FundedNext, Alpha, BrightFunded, Blue Guardian).
- Where profitable days are required (The5ers, Maven, FundingPips 95%), never construct them with tiny trades; use the daily profit target of 26.4.
- Funded: trade each cycle to its target, stop, request the payout on the first allowed day, withdraw all profit.

# Before you start

## 25.1 Requirements

- Adult (18+), with each firm's identity check in your own name and from a country the firm accepts. One registration per firm.
- Money you can lose entirely, never borrowed: at least the bad-case cash low point of the version you run (Chapter 31): about \$47K for eleven firms, \$53K for FTMO alone.
- Each firm's current objectives, prohibited practices, payout terms and allocation cap, read in full and saved with the date.

## 25.2 Platforms, programs and copying

| Firm          | Your own program (EA)                                | Copying between your own accounts                        |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| FTMO          | allowed (no hyperactivity)                           | allowed, within the \$400,000 cap                        |
| FundingPips   | check                                                | own FundingPips accounts only; no copier services        |
| Alpha Capital | check                                                | from your own external accounts, with proof of ownership |
| BrightFunded  | allowed; trades must last at least 60 seconds        | allowed between your own accounts, any firm              |
| Blue Guardian | check                                                | your own accounts only                                   |
| The5ers       | only with written approval                           | allowed across your own accounts                         |
| FXIFY         | allowed on Two-Phase                                 | only after FXIFY approves a request                      |
| GFT           | your own only; no third-party or "marketed" strategy | not between GFT accounts: keep one                       |
| FunderPro     | allowed                                              | no replicating across FunderPro accounts: keep one       |
| Maven         | check                                                | own 2-Step accounts                                      |
| FundedNext    | check                                                | never with a funded account: keep one, trade gold        |

Where no program is allowed or approved, place orders by hand. Across firms, either place each firm's orders yourself or run a separate copy of your own program on each account; never use a third-party copy service.

## 25.3 Measure costs and the hourly move

1. On each firm's demo, write down the value of one point per lot (V) for the Nasdaq (and gold for FundedNext), and the minimum and maximum lot size per order.
2. Average the spread over a US afternoon (14:00–20:00 UTC) and add about 0.6 points for slippage. If the Nasdaq total is above about 3 points, expect a third less value at that firm.

#### HOURLY MOVE (SIMPLE VERSION)

*hourly move  $\approx$  average of  $|close - previous\ close|$  over the last 100 hourly bars  $\times 1.25$  (recompute every Monday)*

# The trade, step by step

## 26.1 The formulas (any account size S)

### RISK

$room = balance - floor$      $day\ room = daily\ limit - (start-of-day\ balance - current\ equity)$

$risk = \min(1.5\% \times S, room - 0.1\% \times S, day\ room - 0.2\% \times S)$

### STOP, LOTS, COST

$stop\ points = 0.75 \times hourly\ move$      $lots = risk \div (stop\ points \times V)$      $cost\ \$ \approx (spread + 0.6) \times lots \times V$

### TARGET

$to\ go = phase\ (or\ cycle)\ target\ balance - balance$

$target\ \$ = \min(5 \times risk, to\ go + cost\ \$ + \$5, today's\ remaining\ daily\ target\ or\ cap)$      $target\ points = target\ \$ \div (lots \times V)$

If the lots exceed a firm's maximum per order, place the position as two orders at the same moment with the same stop and target, or reduce the risk to fit.

## 26.2 Worked examples (100K, hourly move 85 points, V = \$1, spread 1.4 points)

| Situation                    | Balance   | Room to floor | Day room | Risk    | Lots  | Cost | Target \$ | Target pts | Win chance |
|------------------------------|-----------|---------------|----------|---------|-------|------|-----------|------------|------------|
| Phase 1, start               | \$100,000 | \$10,000      | \$5,000  | \$1,500 | 23.43 | \$47 | \$7,500   | 320        | 17%        |
| Phase 1, near target         | \$106,500 | \$16,500      | \$5,000  | \$1,500 | 23.43 | \$47 | \$3,552   | 152        | 30%        |
| Phase 1, after a bad morning | \$95,400  | \$5,400       | \$1,400  | \$1,200 | 18.75 | \$38 | \$6,000   | 320        | 17%        |
| Phase 1, near the floor      | \$90,900  | \$900         | \$5,000  | \$800   | 12.50 | \$25 | \$4,000   | 320        | 17%        |
| Phase 2, near target         | \$104,000 | \$14,000      | \$5,000  | \$1,500 | 23.43 | \$47 | \$1,052   | 45         | 59%        |

## 26.3 Direction

### SHARED DIRECTION (NASDAQ ACCOUNTS)

*If any of your accounts holds a Nasdaq position: same direction as that position.*

*Otherwise: long if the last completed hourly close is above the close 5 hours earlier, short if it is below.*

The gold account (FundedNext) uses the same 5-hour rule on gold, by itself. Gold and the Nasdaq are different markets, so its positions are neither copies of nor hedges against the others. The rule is chosen for being simple and common, not because it did best in Chapter 22's sample.

## 26.4 Daily profit targets and caps

- **Profitable days required** (The5ers and Maven in each phase; FundingPips 95% in each funded cycle; a profitable day is at least +0.5%): until enough profitable days are done, each day's profit target is the larger of 0.55% and  $(\text{distance left} \div \text{profitable days still needed})$ . Stop for the day when it is reached. Risk stays 1.5% on every trade.
- **Best-day rules** (Maven funded after \$5,000 of payouts: 50%): cap the take-profit so that no day exceeds the limit.
- **GFT funded:** at most \$3,000 profit a day; the take-profit never exceeds what is left of it.

# Firm-by-firm rule sheet

## VERSION 5 NOTE

Six firms in this chapter (Alpha Capital, BrightFunded, Blue Guardian, FunderPro, Maven, GFT) have since had their TrustPilot rating withheld for fake reviews. Part 3 (Chapters 33–35) re-ranks the firms, adds Fintokey and Hola Prime, and revises the per-person plan.

Summarised from public sources in October 2026 (Appendix D). Rules change often. Before buying, check each line against the firm's current terms, and get anything marked "check" confirmed in writing.

| Programme (100K)                 | Targets          | Daily / max loss                     | Minimum days                             | Funded payouts                                   | Fee refund                           |
|----------------------------------|------------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| <b>FTMO 2-Step</b>               | 10% / 5%         | 5% / 10% static                      | 4 per phase                              | every 14 days, 80%                               | 1st payout                           |
| <b>FundingPips Flex 95%</b>      | 10% / 6%         | 4% / 12% static                      | none                                     | every 14 days, 95% (3 profitable days per cycle) | 4th payout (assumed)                 |
| <b>Alpha Capital Pro 10%</b>     | 10% / 5%         | 5% / 10% static                      | 3 per phase                              | 14-day cycle, 80%                                | not assumed                          |
| <b>BrightFunded Classic</b>      | 10% / 5%         | 5% / 10% static                      | 5 per phase                              | day 30, then every 14 days, 80%                  | 1st payout                           |
| <b>Blue Guardian 2-Step</b>      | 8% / 4%          | 4% / 8%                              | 3 per phase                              | every 14 days, 85%                               | not assumed                          |
| <b>The5ers High Stakes</b>       | 10% / 5%         | 5% / 10%                             | 3 profitable days ( $\geq 0.5\%$ )       | every 14 days, 80%                               | check                                |
| <b>FXIFY Two-Phase</b>           | 10% / 5%         | 5% / 10% (one source: 4% / trailing) | check                                    | 14 days 80% or 30 days 100%                      | 1st payout                           |
| <b>GFT 2-Step Standard</b>       | 10% / 5%         | 5% / 10% static                      | check                                    | every 14 days, 80%                               | refundable                           |
| <b>FunderPro Classic</b>         | 10% / 8%         | 5% / 10% static                      | none                                     | every 14 days, 80%                               | 1st payout                           |
| <b>Maven 2-Step</b>              | 8% / 5%          | 4% / 8% static                       | 3 profitable days ( $\geq 0.5\%$ )       | about every 10 business days, 80%                | 3rd payout                           |
| <b>FundedNext Stellar 2-Step</b> | 8% / 5%          | 5% / 10% static                      | 5 per phase                              | day 21, then every 14 days, 80%                  | 1st payout; +15% of challenge profit |
| Programme (100K)                 | Weekend (funded) | News (funded)                        | Other limits                             |                                                  |                                      |
| <b>FTMO 2-Step</b>               | no               | $\pm 2$ min                          | none                                     |                                                  |                                      |
| <b>FundingPips Flex 95%</b>      | no               | $\pm 5$ min                          | risk per idea $\leq 2\%$                 |                                                  |                                      |
| <b>Alpha Capital Pro 10%</b>     | no               | $\pm 2$ min                          | risk $< 2\%$ ; best day 40% on on-demand |                                                  |                                      |

| Programme (100K)                 | Weekend (funded) | News (funded) | Other limits                                     |
|----------------------------------|------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------|
| <b>BrightFunded Classic</b>      | allowed          | ±5 min        | trades ≥ 60 s                                    |
| <b>Blue Guardian 2-Step</b>      | check            | check         | funded: shield at –2% open loss                  |
| <b>The5ers High Stakes</b>       | allowed          | ±2 min        | programs need approval                           |
| <b>FXIFY Two-Phase</b>           | allowed          | allowed       | copying needs approval                           |
| <b>GFT 2-Step Standard</b>       | check            | check         | funded ≤ \$3,000/day; first 2 payouts ≤ 6%       |
| <b>FunderPro Classic</b>         | check            | check         | risk per trade ≤ 2%                              |
| <b>Maven 2-Step</b>              | check            | check         | \$10,000 per 30 days; 50% best day after \$5,000 |
| <b>FundedNext Stellar 2-Step</b> | check            | check         | no copying with funded accounts                  |

"check": not found in a reliable public source; ask the firm before buying. The plan is flat at weekends and around news on every account, so those columns rarely bind.

#### THE RULES THAT APPLY EVERYWHERE

- No opposite positions in correlated markets across any of your accounts, at any firm, at any time.
- Everything in your own name; no third-party account management; no signals or copy services from others.
- Stay under each firm's cap, and within its rules on how many accounts may carry the same trades.
- No exploiting platform errors, latency or price feeds; no tick scalping; no trades shorter than a minute.
- Minimum trading days may be met with small, real trades; profitable days may not be manufactured.
- Respect each firm's news windows and weekend rules on funded accounts (the plan is flat for both).

# Running many accounts: the daily routine

## 28.1 The work

| Version                         | Entry moments per trading day | Order tickets per trading day | Busy day (1 in 10) |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------|
| One account per firm (11)       | 8                             | 27                            | 49                 |
| Two per firm where allowed (16) | 8                             | 40                            | 72                 |
| Full caps (25)                  | 8                             | 62                            | 114                |
| FTMO only (4)                   | 5                             | 18                            | 29                 |

Lockstep engine averages over simulated trading days.

At 1 : 5 a full-size trade lasts about four to eight hours including waiting. Nasdaq accounts usually enter together, so the day has a handful of entry moments, each with an order ticket per free account, sized for that account's own balance.

## 28.2 What a program does on each account

| Step | Action                                                                                                                           |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1    | If this account has a position open, do nothing until it closes.                                                                 |
| 2    | Outside 01:00–20:00 UTC Monday–Friday, after 19:00 UTC Friday, or within the news window: wait.                                  |
| 3    | Read balance, start-of-day balance, the current phase or cycle target and any daily target or cap. If a target is reached, stop. |
| 4    | Compute risk (26.1). If the day room is below 0.3% of the account, wait for the next day.                                        |
| 5    | Read the shared direction (26.3) from a file that all your programs read.                                                        |
| 6    | Compute stop, lots, cost and target. Send a market order with both attached.                                                     |
| 7    | Log: time, account, balance, risk, lots, stop, target, direction, fill, result, cost.                                            |
| 8    | Friday 20:30 UTC: close any open position. Funded: close 10 minutes before a listed release.                                     |

Run each program on a free demo for two weeks first. Where a firm requires approval for programs (The5ers) or copying (FXIFY), get it in writing first, or trade by hand.

# Funded accounts and payouts

## 29.1 Cycles of the full allowance

On every funded account, trade the normal plan with the cycle target at the allowance (+10%; +12% at FundingPips Flex; +8% at Maven; +7% for GFT's first cycle). When it is reached, stop; request a payout of all profit on the first allowed day. About one cycle in two ends at the target and one in two ends the account: that is expected. Half of funded accounts end before their first payout, and then the fee is not refunded either; that is the price of the faster cycle. A first cycle of only +\$1,000 makes the first payout and refund far more likely (91%) at a cost of about a sixth of the value per month (Section 19.3).

## 29.2 What each firm's funded account delivers

| Programme                    | Attempts that reach funded | Paid per funded account (average) | Funded account lasts (days) | First payout (day, median) |
|------------------------------|----------------------------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------|
| FTMO 2-Step                  | 30%                        | \$7,500                           | 16                          | 26                         |
| FundingPips 2-Step Flex, 95% | 33%                        | \$10,200                          | 21                          | 23                         |
| Alpha Capital Pro 10%        | 30%                        | \$7,200                           | 16                          | 24                         |
| BrightFunded 2-Step Classic  | 30%                        | \$7,200                           | 23                          | 44                         |
| Blue Guardian 2-Step         | 31%                        | \$5,800                           | 13                          | 24                         |
| The5ers High Stakes          | 30%                        | \$7,300                           | 17                          | 28                         |
| FXIFY Two-Phase              | 30%                        | \$7,000                           | 16                          | 22                         |
| GFT 2-Step Standard          | 30%                        | \$6,800                           | 25                          | 22                         |
| FunderPro Classic            | 25%                        | \$7,200                           | 16                          | 23                         |
| Maven 2-Step                 | 27%                        | \$5,500                           | 18                          | 28                         |
| FundedNext Stellar 2-Step    | 33%                        | \$8,200                           | 19                          | 35                         |

## 29.3 Milestones of one FTMO attempt

| Milestone, FTMO 2-Step, from the day you buy                 | Typical day                |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Phase 1 decided (pass about 47%)                             | day 4 (middle half 3–5)    |
| Phase 2 decided (pass about 64% of those who reach it)       | day 10.5                   |
| Funded account issued                                        | day 11                     |
| First payout received, fee refunded (47% of funded accounts) | day 26 (middle half 25–27) |

Milestone, FTMO 2-Step, from the day you buy

Typical day

Funded account ends

day 20 (middle half 15-33)

# Signing up: the first three months, simulated

What happens if you open the default eleven accounts on one Monday? The lockstep engine was run for 160 simulated years from different start dates and price paths. The table shows cumulative cash (payouts received minus fees paid) week by week.

| After   | Eleven firms: bad (1 in 10) | typical          | good (1 in 10) | ahead | FTMO only: typical | ahead |
|---------|-----------------------------|------------------|----------------|-------|--------------------|-------|
| Week 1  | -\$13,400                   | <b>-\$9,100</b>  | -\$5,600       | 0%    | -\$2,500           | 0%    |
| Week 2  | -\$18,900                   | <b>-\$12,900</b> | -\$7,200       | 0%    | -\$5,100           | 0%    |
| Week 3  | -\$24,900                   | <b>-\$17,000</b> | -\$8,900       | 2%    | -\$7,600           | 0%    |
| Week 4  | -\$30,500                   | <b>-\$18,400</b> | \$17,100       | 22%   | -\$7,900           | 12%   |
| Week 6  | -\$35,300                   | <b>\$200</b>     | \$52,100       | 51%   | -\$12,600          | 30%   |
| Week 8  | -\$34,600                   | <b>\$24,600</b>  | \$100,500      | 69%   | -\$1,100           | 50%   |
| Week 10 | -\$22,800                   | <b>\$53,000</b>  | \$132,100      | 78%   | \$16,800           | 66%   |
| Week 13 | -\$700                      | <b>\$71,800</b>  | \$181,200      | 89%   | \$14,300           | 70%   |
| Week 17 | \$30,100                    | <b>\$108,500</b> | \$234,300      | 95%   | \$37,400           | 76%   |
| Week 26 | \$83,300                    | <b>\$219,600</b> | \$371,600      | 97%   | \$82,500           | 84%   |

Cumulative cash from the day all accounts are opened; 160 simulated years per version.

The first payout typically arrives on day 29 with eleven firms (one year in ten: after day 44), against day 55 with four FTMO accounts, whose results move together. The first month is almost always negative: fees are paid at once, and every failed evaluation is replaced the same day.

## 30.1 One median year, week by week (full caps, firms added month by month)

| Week | Evaluations bought | Fees    | Phase 1 pass / fail | Funded / Phase 2 fail | Funded lost | Payouts (firms) | Cash in | Cumulative cash |
|------|--------------------|---------|---------------------|-----------------------|-------------|-----------------|---------|-----------------|
| 1    | 4                  | \$2,528 | 4 / 0               | 0 / 0                 | 0           | –               | –       | –\$2,528        |
| 2    | 0                  | \$0     | 0 / 0               | 4 / 0                 | 0           | –               | –       | –\$2,528        |
| 3    | 4                  | \$2,528 | 0 / 0               | 0 / 0                 | 4           | –               | –       | –\$5,056        |
| 4    | 4                  | \$2,528 | 4 / 0               | 0 / 4                 | 0           | –               | –       | –\$7,584        |
| 5    | 10                 | \$4,974 | 4 / 5               | 0 / 0                 | 0           | –               | –       | –\$12,558       |
| 6    | 13                 | \$7,543 | 0 / 9               | 0 / 4                 | 0           | –               | –       | –\$20,101       |
| 7    | 12                 | \$7,052 | 5 / 12              | 0 / 0                 | 0           | –               | –       | –\$27,153       |

| Week            | Evaluations<br>bought | Fees    | Phase 1 pass<br>/ fail |        | Funded /<br>Phase 2 fail |        | Funded<br>lost | Payouts<br>(firms) | Cash in  | Cumulative<br>cash |        |        |
|-----------------|-----------------------|---------|------------------------|--------|--------------------------|--------|----------------|--------------------|----------|--------------------|--------|--------|
| 8               | 0                     | \$0     | 4 / 0                  |        | 5 / 0                    |        | 0              | –                  | –        | –\$27,153          |        |        |
| 9               | 10                    | \$5,078 | 0 / 1                  |        | 4 / 0                    |        | 5              | –                  | –        | –\$32,231          |        |        |
| 10              | 0                     | \$0     | 2 / 0                  |        | 0 / 0                    |        | 0              | –                  | –        | –\$32,231          |        |        |
| 11              | 7                     | \$3,487 | 7 / 0                  |        | 2 / 7                    |        | 0              | 4 (FTMO)           | \$34,531 | –\$1,187           |        |        |
| 12              | 0                     | \$0     | 7 / 0                  |        | 4 / 0                    |        | 0              | –                  | –        | –\$1,187           |        |        |
| 13              | 13                    | \$6,721 | 3 / 0                  |        | 3 / 0                    |        | 4              | 4 (FTMO)           | \$32,000 | \$24,092           |        |        |
|                 |                       |         |                        |        |                          |        |                |                    |          |                    |        |        |
| Month           | 1                     | 2       | 3                      | 4      | 5                        | 6      | 7              | 8                  | 9        | 10                 | 11     | 12     |
| Cumulative cash | –\$10K                | –\$30K  | \$24K                  | \$112K | \$227K                   | \$340K | \$401K         | \$548K             | \$690K   | \$700K             | \$867K | \$968K |

Lowest point of cumulative cash in this year: -\$33,700.

This is the simulated year with the median 12-month result among 60 runs. Note the pattern: weeks of fees with nothing coming back, four funded FTMO accounts lost together before their first payout, then large months once several funded accounts pay at the same time. The same lumpiness holds for every version of the plan.

# Month by month: cash, odds and when to stop

## 31.1 What to expect

| Version                   | Months | Chance ahead | Median cash | Bad case (1 in 20) | Good case (1 in 20) |
|---------------------------|--------|--------------|-------------|--------------------|---------------------|
| One account per firm (11) | 1      | 31%          | -\$18K      | -\$34K             | \$49K               |
|                           | 3      | 90%          | \$80K       | -\$22K             | \$216K              |
|                           | 6      | 98%          | \$245K      | \$57K              | \$407K              |
|                           | 12     | 100%         | \$531K      | \$307K             | \$730K              |
| Full caps (25)            | 1      | 30%          | -\$43K      | -\$86K             | \$132K              |
|                           | 3      | 84%          | \$184K      | -\$65K             | \$469K              |
|                           | 6      | 98%          | \$556K      | \$106K             | \$941K              |
|                           | 12     | 100%         | \$1,221K    | \$675K             | \$1,763K            |
| FTMO only (4)             | 1      | 21%          | -\$10K      | -\$18K             | \$32K               |
|                           | 3      | 79%          | \$17K       | -\$35K             | \$123K              |
|                           | 6      | 89%          | \$92K       | -\$26K             | \$192K              |
|                           | 12     | 95%          | \$193K      | \$2K               | \$338K              |

Cumulative cash (payouts minus fees), all accounts opened at the start, lockstep engine. Cash low points are in Chapter 21.

## 31.2 Bankroll rules

- Hold the bad-case cash low point of 31.1 for the version you run, in cash you can lose.
- Add firms or accounts only from payouts already received.
- Withdraw payouts to a separate account; only the planned budget buys new attempts.
- Fix in advance how many months you will run before reviewing.

## 31.3 Checks that the assumptions hold

| Check                                                | Expected             | Stop and review if |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|--------------------|
| Win rate of full-size 1 : 5 trades (after 600)       | ≈ 16.7% before costs | below 13%          |
| Average cost per trade (spread, slippage, financing) | ≈ 3–4% of the risk   | above 5.5%         |

| Check                                                | Expected | Stop and review if                                                                          |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Phase 1 pass rate (after 20 attempts at 10% targets) | ≈ 46%    | 4 or fewer passes                                                                           |
| Payouts honoured                                     | all      | any refusal: stop at that firm, read the stated reason, review the others                   |
| Rule changes                                         | none     | any change to caps, payouts, copying, news or risk rules: re-check before the next purchase |

## 31.4 If firms refuse payouts

Every figure so far assumes all payouts are paid. Suppose instead that each payout request is refused with some probability, and that a refusal also ends that firm for you (no further purchases there). Applied to 1,000 simulated years of the default plan (one account at each of eleven firms):

| Chance each payout is refused | First-year average per month | vs all paid | Firms lost in the year | Ahead after 12 months | 12-month cash, bad case (1 in 20) |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------|------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 0%                            | \$43,800                     | –           | 0.0                    | 100%                  | \$313K                            |
| 2%                            | \$39,400                     | -10%        | 1.8                    | 100%                  | \$263K                            |
| 5%                            | \$33,600                     | -23%        | 3.9                    | 100%                  | \$223K                            |
| 10%                           | \$25,900                     | -41%        | 6.4                    | 100%                  | \$154K                            |
| 20%                           | \$15,900                     | -64%        | 9.0                    | 100%                  | \$62K                             |

The plan stays ahead after a year in almost every simulated year even when one payout in five is refused, but its value falls steeply, and the firms that refuse are lost for good. This, not the trading, is the main uncertainty in the whole plan.

## 31.5 Tax

Payouts are usually taxable income; fees are often deductible. Keep one ledger of every fee and payout with dates and currencies, and check your country's rules with an adviser.

# Final checklist

- ☐ I am 18 or older and hold, in cash I can lose, the bad-case cash low point for the version I will run.
- ☐ I have read each firm's current objectives, prohibited practices, payout terms and cap, and confirmed every "check" item in writing.
- ☐ I measured Nasdaq (and gold) costs and the point value at every firm.
- ☐ My programs or routine follow Chapter 24 exactly and passed two weeks on demo; approvals obtained where required.
- ☐ One position per account; risk 1.5%; stop and target attached on entry; 1 : 5.
- ☐ Nasdaq accounts share one direction; no account ever opposes another; FundedNext trades gold on its own.
- ☐ Only one account at GFT, FunderPro, FundedNext, FXIFY, The5ers and Maven.
- ☐ Daily guard, news rule, Friday close, daily profit targets and caps are in place.
- ☐ Everything is in my own name; I do not share, sell or copy this plan to or from anyone.
- ☐ I understand that about seven attempts in ten lose the fee, that the first month is usually negative, and that firms may refuse payouts or change rules.

## THE WHOLE DOCUMENT IN SIX LINES

A zero-skill trade is a fair bet, so a phase passes with probability  $B \div (A + B)$ . A funded account pays out, on average, the split times its loss allowance. Time is set by the instrument's cost per unit of movement, the stop, the reward-to-risk ratio and the firm's calendar. The best plan found is one Nasdaq position at a time, stop 0.75 hourly moves, 1 : 5, risk 1.5%, funded cycles of the full allowance. One account at each of eleven firms is worth about \$49,000 a month in theory; the full caps about \$114,000, with far more failed accounts per firm. The firms' discretion is the one thing the maths cannot price.

# **Version 5: firms you can trust, more of them, and the plan revised**

Checked on 4 October 2026. Six of the eleven firms in the version 4 plan have had their public reviews flagged as manipulated. This part sorts every firm by how far its public record can be trusted, adds two firms with clean records, prices in the chance that payouts are refused, and revises the per-person plan. The trade itself (Chapters 24–26) does not change.

## Which firms to trust

Every firm keeps the right to refuse a payout it judges to break its rules, so in the end each payout is the firm's decision. The main outside check on whether a firm pays is what its funded traders say in public. In August and September 2026 TrustPilot withheld the ratings of six of the eleven firms in the version 4 plan, each with the notices “This company's rating is unavailable due to a breach of our guidelines” and “We've removed a number of fake reviews for this company”. PropFirmMap downgraded each of them to D. Every notice below was read on the firms' TrustPilot pages on 4 October 2026.

### 33.1 The firms, by tier

| Firm                            | TrustPilot score          | Reviews | One-star share | PropFirmMap grade | Tier     |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------|---------|----------------|-------------------|----------|
| <b>FTMO</b>                     | 4.8                       | 53,729  | 3%             | A+                | <b>A</b> |
| <b>The5ers</b>                  | 4.7                       | 39,102  | 3%             | A+                | <b>A</b> |
| <b>FundingPips</b>              | 4.5                       | 69,773  | –              | A+                | <b>A</b> |
| <b>FundedNext</b>               | 4.5                       | 80,781  | 7%             | A+                | <b>A</b> |
| <b>FXIFY</b>                    | 4.3                       | 6,373   | –              | A+                | <b>A</b> |
| <b>Topstep (futures)</b>        | 3.6                       | 14,881  | –              | A                 | <b>A</b> |
| <b>Hola Prime (new)</b>         | 4.5                       | 3,882   | –              | B+                | <b>B</b> |
| <b>Fintokei (new)</b>           | 4.3                       | 1,387   | –              | B+                | <b>B</b> |
| <b>Apex (futures)</b>           | 4.2                       | 21,157  | –              | B+                | <b>B</b> |
| <b>Alpha Capital</b>            | withheld                  | 21,822  | 7%             | D                 | <b>D</b> |
| <b>Maven</b>                    | withheld                  | 5,207   | 9%             | D                 | <b>D</b> |
| <b>BrightFunded</b>             | withheld                  | 572     | 20%            | D                 | <b>D</b> |
| <b>Blue Guardian</b>            | withheld (since Aug 2025) | 2,091   | 23%            | D                 | <b>D</b> |
| <b>FunderPro</b>                | withheld                  | 1,559   | 35%            | D                 | <b>D</b> |
| <b>Goat Funded Trader (GFT)</b> | withheld                  | 4,342   | 40%            | D                 | <b>D</b> |

Read on [trustpilot.com](https://trustpilot.com) and [propfirmmap.com](https://propfirmmap.com) on 4 October 2026. "Withheld": the page says "This company's rating is unavailable due to a breach of our guidelines" and "We've removed a number of fake reviews for this company". One-star shares were recorded for the flagged firms and for three of the others.

### 33.2 What a withheld rating does and does not mean

It is a finding about reviews, not about payouts: fake praise was posted for the firm. It does not prove that the firm refuses payouts. But it removes the best public evidence that the firm pays, and the reviews that remain are telling: one in three at FunderPro and two in five at GFT are one-star,

and PropFirmMap notes many payout-denial complaints at FunderPro. Version 4 assumed every payout is paid. Version 5 keeps that figure and adds two scenarios that put a chance of refusal on each tier:

| Scenario                | Tier A    | Tier B    | Tier D     |
|-------------------------|-----------|-----------|------------|
| All paid (versions 1–4) | 0%        | 0%        | 0%         |
| <b>Tiered</b>           | <b>2%</b> | <b>5%</b> | <b>15%</b> |
| Harsh                   | 5%        | 10%       | 30%        |

Chance that each payout is refused. A refusal usually comes with the account closed, so after the first refusal the simulated person stops using that firm: no more fees and no more payouts there.

These chances are judgements, not measurements: no firm publishes how many payouts it refuses. They are there to show how the plan behaves if the flags mean what they might mean.

### 33.3 What it does to the version 4 plan

| Version 4 plan                                     | Steady month, every payout paid | Tiered refusals | Harsh refusals  |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| Version 4 default: one account at each of 11 firms | \$49,100                        | \$32,700 (-34%) | \$23,400 (-52%) |
| Version 4 full caps (25)                           | \$113,600                       | \$52,400 (-54%) | \$32,100 (-72%) |

Lockstep engine, 200 simulated years per plan on 8 zero-edge paths; each simulated year replayed 10 times with random refusals. Steady month = average of months 3–12.

Version 4's full caps put 14 of its 25 accounts at tier-D firms. Under the tiered scenario it loses more than half its value; the one-account-per-firm default loses about a third. A firm with many accounts makes many payout requests, and each request is another chance of losing the whole firm. Spreading accounts across firms protects against that better than stacking them at one firm.

# More accounts at firms that can be trusted

With the tier-D firms discounted, the per-person value now depends on finding more capacity at firms with clean records. Every candidate below was checked against its own rule pages where possible, and against TrustPilot and PropFirmMap.

## 34.1 Firms checked

| Firm or programme                                    | Tier | What was found (4 October 2026)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Decision                                                      |
|------------------------------------------------------|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Fintokei ProTrader</b>                            | B    | 8% / 6%; 5% daily loss from start-of-day equity; 10% static; 3 profitable days per phase; open risk per trade $\leq$ 3%; weekends allowed; 80%; payout every 14 days with at least 3% profit and every position closed; fee returned with the first payout; up to €500,000 per person; copying your own trades allowed                                                                                                  | added: 4 × 100K, Nasdaq                                       |
| <b>Hola Prime 2-Step Prime</b>                       | B    | 8% / 5%; 5% daily loss from the previous close; 10% static; 3 trading days per phase; funded: stop on every trade, risk $\leq$ 2%, 80% every 14 days with 3 profitable days, best day $\leq$ 40% of the payout; fee returned 25% with each of the first four payouts; \$500,000 per person; copying only between your own Hola Prime accounts (one master, one copier); <i>copying from other prop firms prohibited</i> | added: 2 × 100K on USDJPY, independent of the Nasdaq accounts |
| <b>The5ers High Stakes, small sizes</b>              | A    | Next to the 100K account a person may hold 1 × 25K, 3 × 10K, 3 × 5K and 3 × 2.5K High Stakes accounts (\$176, \$69, \$35, \$19), copying allowed                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | optional: +10 accounts                                        |
| <b>Topstep 50K (futures)</b>                         | A    | \$49 a month + \$149 activation; \$3,000 target; \$2,000 end-of-day trailing; best day $\leq$ 55% of the target; funded: 5 winning days of \$150+, $\leq$ 50% of the balance and $\leq$ \$2,000 per request, 90%; up to 5 funded accounts                                                                                                                                                                               | optional futures layer: 5                                     |
| <b>Apex 4.0 50K EOD (futures)</b>                    | B    | \$550 list, public 80–90% codes (about \$55) + \$99 activation on passing; 30-day evaluations; \$2,000 end-of-day trailing; flat by 4:59 pm ET; 100% for at most 6 payouts; 50% consistency; up to 20 funded accounts, copying between your own allowed                                                                                                                                                                 | optional futures layer: 20, only at 80–90% off                |
| <b>OANDA Prop Trader</b>                             | –    | Closed: FTMO bought OANDA (completed December 2025) and moved the prop business into FTMO by 31 March 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | –                                                             |
| <b>Blueberry Funded</b>                              | D    | TrustPilot rating withheld; funded loss per trade capped at 1.5%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | not added                                                     |
| <b>ThinkCapital</b>                                  | D    | TrustPilot rating withheld (broker-owned)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | not added                                                     |
| <b>E8 Markets</b>                                    | D    | TrustPilot rating withheld; mostly one-step products with trailing or 3% limits                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | not added                                                     |
| <b>Funded Trading Plus</b>                           | D    | TrustPilot rating withheld; its help pages contradict each other on copying                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | not added                                                     |
| <b>FTUK</b>                                          | –    | Two-Step pays only from the third funded level (two more 8% steps first)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | not added                                                     |
| <b>The Trading Pit, AquaFunded, Audacity Capital</b> | D    | TrustPilot ratings withheld                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | not added                                                     |

## 34.2 What each added account is worth

| Programme                                           | Market       | Fee                  | Pass both | Paid per funded account | EV per attempt | EV per month per account | Real path |
|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------------------|-----------|-------------------------|----------------|--------------------------|-----------|
| Fintokei ProTrader                                  | Nasdaq       | \$549                | 30%       | \$7,100                 | \$1,584        | <b>\$3,500</b> ±141      | \$4,000   |
| Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, bi-weekly 80%              | USDJPY       | \$599                | 33%       | \$6,700                 | \$1,594        | <b>\$4,100</b> ±151      | \$3,800   |
| Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, monthly 95%                | USDJPY       | \$599                | 33%       | \$7,200                 | \$1,789        | <b>\$3,300</b> ±104      | \$3,200   |
| ... the same on the Nasdaq (not used: copying rule) | Nasdaq       | \$599                | 34%       | \$6,900                 | \$1,750        | <b>\$4,300</b> ±149      | \$4,400   |
| FundedNext Stellar 2-Step (version 4: gold)         | USDJPY       | \$550                | 33%       | \$8,000                 | \$2,085        | <b>\$4,600</b> ±136      | \$4,000   |
| The5ers High Stakes 25K                             | Nasdaq       | \$176                | 30%       | \$1,800                 | \$361          | <b>\$790</b> ±36         | \$860     |
| The5ers High Stakes 10K                             | Nasdaq       | \$69                 | 30%       | \$740                   | \$149          | <b>\$320</b> ±14         | \$350     |
| The5ers High Stakes 5K                              | Nasdaq       | \$35                 | 30%       | \$360                   | \$72           | <b>\$160</b> ±7          | \$170     |
| The5ers High Stakes 2.5K                            | Nasdaq       | \$19                 | 29%       | \$180                   | \$32           | <b>\$70</b> ±4           | \$90      |
| Topstep 50K (futures)                               | micro Nasdaq | \$49 a month + \$149 | 24%       | \$810                   | \$107          | <b>\$960</b> ±225        | \$2,000   |
| Apex 50K EOD at 90% off (\$55 + \$99)               | micro Nasdaq | \$55 + \$99          | 37%       | \$610                   | \$135          | <b>\$550</b> ±48         | \$360     |
| Apex 50K EOD at 80% off (\$110 + \$99)              | micro Nasdaq | \$110 + \$99         | 37%       | \$610                   | \$80           | <b>\$320</b> ±54         | \$130     |

The plan of Part 2 (stop 0.75 hourly moves, 1 : 5, risk 1.5% of the account, cycles of +10%); futures as in Chapter 20. 24,000 synthetic attempts per row and 8,000 on the real 2024–26 path (the yen rows use the real USDJPY series).

Fintokei is a static-loss 2-step like FTMO; its three profitable days per phase and its 6% second phase make it a little slower. Hola Prime's best-day and profitable-day rules slow its funded cycles; its monthly 95% option is worse than bi-weekly 80% because the money arrives later. The5ers' small accounts follow the same rules but cost more per dollar of allowance, so ten of them add only about \$2,500 a month. Futures remain thin: Apex pays only at 80–90% off, which it has offered almost continuously in 2026, but a code that disappears would turn it negative.

## 34.3 Which market an independent account should trade

Hola Prime forbids copying trades from accounts at other prop firms, and FundedNext forbids copying once an account is funded. Their accounts therefore trade their own market, never repeating the Nasdaq trades. Each needs a different market from every other independent account, or the two would repeat each other's trades.

| Market     | Stop (hourly moves) | EV per month | vs Nasdaq |
|------------|---------------------|--------------|-----------|
| Nasdaq 100 | 0.75                | \$4,700      | –         |

| Market  | Stop (hourly moves) | EV per month | vs Nasdaq |
|---------|---------------------|--------------|-----------|
| USDJPY  | 0.75                | \$4,600      | -2%       |
| USDJPY  | 1.00                | \$4,200      | -10%      |
| Gold    | 0.75                | \$4,300      | -8%       |
| S&P 500 | 0.75                | \$4,200      | -10%      |
| EURUSD  | 1.00                | \$3,300      | -30%      |
| GBPUSD  | 1.00                | \$3,100      | -34%      |

FundedNext Stellar 2-Step rules, random direction, 24,000 synthetic attempts per row. The S&P 500 moves with the Nasdaq (correlation about 0.9), so it cannot be traded against the Nasdaq accounts: it is no independent market.

USDJPY is nearly as good as the Nasdaq: its cost per unit of movement is low and it trades from 00:00 UTC. Gold costs about 8%; the euro and pound cost about a third. Version 5 trades FundedNext on gold (as in version 4) and Hola Prime on USDJPY, both with the plan's stop of 0.75 hourly moves.

## 34.4 Fee discounts

| Programme                               | List fee | EV per month | Gain from 10% off | Relative |
|-----------------------------------------|----------|--------------|-------------------|----------|
| FTMO 2-Step                             | \$632    | \$4,200      | +\$141            | +3.4%    |
| FundingPips 2-Step Flex, 95%            | \$499    | \$6,200      | +\$105            | +1.7%    |
| The5ers High Stakes                     | \$491    | \$3,800      | +\$92             | +2.4%    |
| FXIFY Two-Phase                         | \$480    | \$5,000      | +\$122            | +2.4%    |
| FundedNext Stellar 2-Step               | \$550    | \$4,300      | +\$108            | +2.5%    |
| Fintokey ProTrader                      | \$549    | \$3,500      | +\$105            | +3.0%    |
| Hola Prime 2-Step Prime (bi-weekly 80%) | \$599    | \$3,600      | +\$132            | +3.7%    |
| Alpha Capital Pro 10%                   | \$497    | \$4,600      | +\$136            | +3.0%    |
| BrightFunded 2-Step Classic             | \$580    | \$3,300      | +\$105            | +3.2%    |
| Blue Guardian 2-Step                    | \$497    | \$4,100      | +\$157            | +3.8%    |
| FunderPro Classic                       | \$431    | \$4,100      | +\$121            | +2.9%    |
| Maven 2-Step                            | \$440    | \$2,400      | +\$96             | +4.0%    |
| GFT 2-Step Standard                     | \$524    | \$3,700      | +\$103            | +2.8%    |

The same attempts priced twice (12,000 synthetic attempts, common random numbers). Where a fee is refunded, the refund is the amount actually paid, so a discount saves money only on attempts that never earn the refund.

Most firms run public discount codes most of the time (FTMO rarely does). A 10% discount adds 2–4% to an account's value, 20% about twice that. Use only the firm's own public codes, check that the discounted account has the same rules, and expect the refund to be the discounted amount.

# The per-person plan, revised

## 35.1 Six versions, with and without refusals

| Version                                                                 | Steady month, all paid | Steady month, tiered refusals | Steady month, harsh refusals | First-year average, all paid | Ahead after 1 / 3 / 12 months | Cash low: typical / 1 in 20 | Most failed accounts at one firm per month |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| Tier A: FTMO 4, FundingPips 4, The5ers, FXIFY, FundedNext (11 accounts) | \$52,100               | <b>\$39,100</b>               | \$27,000                     | \$47,000                     | 28% / 80% / 100%              | -\$24K / -\$62K             | 10                                         |
| Tier A + B: adds Fintokei 4 and Hola Prime 2 (17)                       | \$74,000               | <b>\$49,500</b>               | \$33,400                     | \$66,800                     | 30% / 86% / 100%              | -\$35K / -\$75K             | 10                                         |
| <b>Tier A + B + one account at each tier-D firm (23)</b>                | <b>\$100,500</b>       | <b>\$61,700</b>               | <b>\$39,000</b>              | <b>\$90,300</b>              | <b>32% / 88% / 100%</b>       | <b>-\$44K / -\$97K</b>      | <b>10</b>                                  |
| The same + The5ers small accounts (33)                                  | \$103,000              | <b>\$61,800</b>               | \$37,000                     | \$92,400                     | 32% / 85% / 100%              | -\$46K / -\$102K            | 23                                         |
| All tiers at full caps (31)                                             | \$135,500              | <b>\$62,900</b>               | \$38,200                     | \$120,900                    | 32% / 86% / 100%              | -\$60K / -\$143K            | 12                                         |
| Tier A + B + futures: Topstep 5, Apex 20 (42)                           | \$94,700               | <b>\$53,600</b>               | \$34,900                     | \$84,900                     | 32% / 87% / 100%              | -\$46K / -\$103K            | 73                                         |

Lockstep engine: 200 simulated years per version on 8 independent zero-edge paths, all accounts on one path and calendar, shared direction per market; no opposite positions occurred. Refusal scenarios: each payout refused with probability 2% / 5% / 15% (tiers A / B / D, 'tiered') or 5% / 10% / 30% ('harsh'); after a refusal the firm is dropped.

On the real 2024–26 path (gold and yen accounts mapped to the Nasdaq) the recommended version earned \$130,800 per steady month with every payout paid and \$81,400 with tiered refusals; tier A alone \$65,800 and \$49,800.

## 35.2 What to run

- Recommended: tier A and B in full, one account at each tier-D firm** (23 accounts at 13 firms). Under the tiered scenario it is worth about as much as all tiers at full caps, with a much smaller cash low and far fewer failed accounts per firm, because no single doubtful firm carries much of the value.
- Most cautious: tier A and B only** (17 accounts at 7 firms). Every account is at a firm with a clean public record. It gives up about a fifth of the tiered value.
- Optional extras, in order:** The5ers' small accounts (+10 accounts; little money; many quick failures at one firm); full caps at the tier-D firms (raises the all-paid figure, adds little after refusals); the futures layer (Topstep 5, Apex 20 at 80–90% off: dozens of failed evaluations a month, thin margins, and its value mostly disappears after refusals).
- Keep the plan private.** If several people traded these rules, the same trades on many accounts would become prohibited group trading (Chapter 23).

## 35.3 The recommended accounts

| Firm and programme (100K)                     | Tier | Accounts            | Market              | Funded cycle                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------|------|---------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FTMO 2-Step</b>                            | A    | 4                   | Nasdaq              | +10%                                                 |
| <b>FundingPips 2-Step Flex, 95% split</b>     | A    | 4                   | Nasdaq              | +12%, 3 profitable days per cycle                    |
| <b>The5ers High Stakes 100K</b>               | A    | 1                   | Nasdaq              | +10%                                                 |
| <b>FXIFY Two-Phase</b>                        | A    | 1                   | Nasdaq              | +10%                                                 |
| <b>FundedNext Stellar 2-Step</b>              | A    | 1                   | Gold, independent   | +10%                                                 |
| <b>Fintokei ProTrader</b>                     | B    | 4                   | Nasdaq              | +10% (each payout $\geq 3\%$ , all positions closed) |
| <b>Hola Prime 2-Step Prime, bi-weekly 80%</b> | B    | 2 (master + copier) | USDJPY, independent | +10%; 3 profitable days; best day $\leq 40\%$        |
| <b>Alpha Capital Pro 10%</b>                  | D    | 1                   | Nasdaq              | +10%                                                 |
| <b>BrightFunded 2-Step Classic</b>            | D    | 1                   | Nasdaq              | +10%                                                 |
| <b>Blue Guardian 2-Step</b>                   | D    | 1                   | Nasdaq              | +10% (open loss never 2%)                            |
| <b>GFT 2-Step Standard</b>                    | D    | 1                   | Nasdaq              | +7% first, then +10%; $\leq \$3,000$ a day           |
| <b>FunderPro Classic</b>                      | D    | 1                   | Nasdaq              | +10%                                                 |
| <b>Maven 2-Step</b>                           | D    | 1                   | Nasdaq              | +8%                                                  |

Every Nasdaq account follows the shared direction rule (26.3); the gold and yen accounts each follow the same rule on their own market. Trade sizes, stops, targets, the calendar and the news rules are those of Chapter 24 for every account; at Fintokei also close every position before requesting a payout. Sign-up order, if added month by month: tier A first; then Fintokei and Hola Prime; then the tier-D singles.

## 35.4 Failed accounts per firm

| Firm          | Recommended (23 accounts) | + The5ers small accounts | Tier A + B + futures |
|---------------|---------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|
| Apex          | –                         | –                        | 73.1                 |
| Topstep       | –                         | –                        | 45.0                 |
| FTMO          | 9.7                       | 9.7                      | 9.6                  |
| FundingPips   | 8.5                       | 8.5                      | 8.7                  |
| Fintokei      | 8.6                       | 8.6                      | 8.5                  |
| Hola Prime    | 5.5                       | 5.6                      | 5.5                  |
| Blue Guardian | 3.1                       | 3.1                      | –                    |
| FXIFY         | 2.9                       | 2.9                      | 2.9                  |
| FunderPro     | 2.9                       | 2.9                      | –                    |
| Alpha Capital | 2.7                       | 2.6                      | –                    |
| Maven         | 2.3                       | 2.2                      | –                    |

| Firm         | Recommended (23 accounts) | + The5ers small accounts | Tier A + B + futures |
|--------------|---------------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|
| FundedNext   | 2.3                       | 2.3                      | 2.3                  |
| GFT          | 2.3                       | 2.3                      | –                    |
| The5ers      | 2.1                       | 23.2                     | 2.2                  |
| BrightFunded | 2.0                       | 2.1                      | –                    |

Failed evaluations plus lost funded accounts per firm per month. Several firms list many quick failures as a sign of gambling (Chapter 21.4).

## 35.5 What did not change

The trade (Chapters 24–26), the daily routine (Chapter 28), the payout routine (Chapter 29) and the warnings (Chapters 16, 23 and 31) all stand. The mathematics is unchanged: with no edge, the value comes only from the structure of the contracts, and only if the firms pay.

# Formula sheet and glossary

| Quantity                             | Formula                                                                                 | FTMO 100K example                    |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| Zero-skill win probability           | $p = S \div (S + T)$                                                                    | 1 : 2 → 33.3%                        |
| Pass probability, static floor       | $P = B \div (A + B)$                                                                    | Phase 1: 50%; Phase 2: 66.7%         |
| Pass probability from balance x      | $P(x) = (x + B) \div (A + B)$                                                           | x = -\$5,000: 25%                    |
| With overshoot                       | $P = (B + O_{\text{floor}}) \div (A + O_{\text{target}} + B)$                           | ±\$4,800 fixed: 41%                  |
| Intraday trailing, continuous prices | $P = e^{-A/D}$                                                                          | A = 1.5D → 22.3%                     |
| Funded identity                      | Withdrawn = trading P&L + (start – final balance)                                       | E[withdrawn] = \$10,000              |
| Funded value                         | $\approx \text{split} \times B \times (1 - \text{cost share}) + \text{refund} \times q$ | ≈ \$8,600                            |
| First-payout probability             | $q = B \div (B + h)$                                                                    | h = \$500 → 95.2%                    |
| EV per attempt                       | $-\text{Fee} + \Pi P_i \times (\text{funded value} - \text{activation})$                | +\$2,235 (no costs)                  |
| Cost ratio                           | $\kappa = \text{cost pips} \div \text{stop pips}$                                       | 0.75 ÷ 55 = 1.4%                     |
| Expected trades per phase            | $A \times B \div L^2$                                                                   | L = \$1,000: 100                     |
| Expected cost per phase              | $\kappa \times A \times B \div L$                                                       | L = \$1,000: ≈ \$1,400               |
| Expected trades per phase (1 : k)    | $A \times B \div (k \times L^2)$                                                        | 1.5%, 1 : 3: ≈ 15                    |
| Duration of one bracket              | $\approx k \times s^2 \div \sigma^2$                                                    | s = 0.75σ, 1 : 3: ≈ 1.7 active hours |
| Phase time and cost                  | $\propto (s \div L)^2$ and $\propto c \div (k L s)$                                     | Chapter 8                            |
| Instrument efficiency                | weekly move ÷ round-trip cost                                                           | US100 481, EURUSD 147, BTC 49–63     |
| Tightest stop from leverage λ        | $L \div (\lambda \times \text{size})$                                                   | 1.5% at 1:50: 0.03%                  |
| EV per month per slot                | EV per attempt ÷ attempt length                                                         | Fast plan ≈ \$2,400                  |
| Kelly bankroll for one attempt       | $W \approx \sigma^2 \div \mu$                                                           | ≈ \$4,100–6,000                      |
| Lots (EURUSD)                        | risk ÷ (stop pips × \$10)                                                               | \$1,000, 60 pips → 1.66              |

## Glossary

|                              |                                                                                      |
|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Bold play</b>             | Sizing each bet so a win lands exactly on the target, using as few bets as possible. |
| <b>Bracket</b>               | A trade with stop-loss and take-profit attached on entry.                            |
| <b>Consistency rule</b>      | A limit on how much of total profit one day may contribute.                          |
| <b>EOD trailing drawdown</b> | A floor that rises with the highest end-of-day balance.                              |

|                                   |                                                                             |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Expected value (EV)</b>        | The average result per repetition over many repetitions.                    |
| <b>Fair bet / martingale</b>      | A bet with zero expected value; a sequence of such bets.                    |
| <b>Floor</b>                      | The balance at which the account is closed (\$90,000 for FTMO 100K).        |
| <b>Gambler's ruin</b>             | The problem of reaching one level before another; answer $B \div (A + B)$ . |
| <b>Intraday trailing drawdown</b> | A floor that follows the highest live equity, including open profit.        |
| <b>Kelly criterion</b>            | The stake that maximises long-run growth of wealth.                         |
| <b>Lot</b>                        | Position unit; 1 standard EURUSD lot = 100,000 EUR, \$10 per pip.           |
| <b>Optional stopping theorem</b>  | A fair game stopped by a reasonable rule is still fair on average.          |
| <b>Overshoot</b>                  | Ending beyond a barrier instead of exactly on it.                           |
| <b>Pip</b>                        | 0.0001 in EURUSD.                                                           |
| <b>Profit split</b>               | Your share of withdrawn profit (80% at FTMO).                               |
| <b>Slippage</b>                   | Being filled at a worse price than your order.                              |
| <b>Spread</b>                     | The gap between the buy and sell price.                                     |
| <b>Static drawdown</b>            | A floor fixed relative to the starting balance.                             |

# Every account type modelled

Zero skill, best sizing for each rule set, payouts honoured. "EV" uses 1% trading costs; "1%-risk EV" restricts every trade to 1% of the account (25% of the drawdown for futures). CFD accounts are 100K, futures 50K, prices in USD (EUR at 1.17). Rules as published September–October 2026. † marks rule sets partly inferred; instant-account values ignore payout caps.

| Firm            | Account            | Price | Target / max loss                       | Funded      | P(fund.) | Value   | EV       | 1% risk  |
|-----------------|--------------------|-------|-----------------------------------------|-------------|----------|---------|----------|----------|
| FTMO            | 1-Step             | \$584 | 10/10% EOD trail +cons.                 | 90% × \$10k | 43%      | \$9,376 | +\$3,465 | +\$2,646 |
| Blue Guardian   | Instant            | \$779 | instant                                 | 80% × \$6k  | 100%     | \$3,920 | +\$3,141 | +\$3,062 |
| Goat Funded     | Instant GOAT       | \$838 | instant                                 | 80% × \$6k  | 100%     | \$3,920 | +\$3,082 | +\$3,002 |
| The5ers         | High Stakes 2-Step | \$545 | 8/10% static → 5/10% static             | 80% × \$10k | 36%      | \$8,359 | +\$2,490 | +\$2,054 |
| FundedNext      | Stellar 2-Step     | \$550 | 8/10% static → 5/10% static             | 80% × \$10k | 36%      | \$8,364 | +\$2,486 | +\$2,056 |
| FundingPips     | 2-Step             | \$529 | 8/10% static → 5/10% static             | 80% × \$10k | 36%      | \$8,281 | +\$2,477 | +\$2,043 |
| Alpha Capital † | Alpha Pro 10%      | \$497 | 10/10% static → 5/10% static            | 80% × \$10k | 33%      | \$8,313 | +\$2,215 | +\$1,794 |
| FTMO            | 2-Step             | \$632 | 10/10% static → 5/10% static            | 80% × \$10k | 33%      | \$8,442 | +\$2,122 | +\$1,697 |
| Goat Funded †   | 2-Step Standard    | \$594 | 10/10% static → 5/10% static            | 80% × \$10k | 33%      | \$7,840 | +\$1,964 | +\$1,556 |
| FundedNext      | Stellar Lite       | \$400 | 8/8% static → 4/8% static               | 80% × \$8k  | 33%      | \$6,272 | +\$1,646 | +\$1,398 |
| Blue Guardian † | 2-Step Pro         | \$464 | 10/10% EOD trail → 10/10% EOD trail     | 85% × \$10k | 24%      | \$8,330 | +\$1,556 | +\$597   |
| Maven †         | 2-Step             | \$396 | 8/8% static → 5/8% static               | 80% × \$8k  | 30%      | \$6,272 | +\$1,490 | +\$1,257 |
| Alpha Capital † | Alpha Pro 8%       | \$577 | 8/8% static → 5/8% static               | 80% × \$8k  | 30%      | \$6,815 | +\$1,473 | +\$1,227 |
| FundedNext      | Stellar 1-Step     | \$570 | 10/6% static                            | 90% × \$6k  | 37%      | \$5,292 | +\$1,374 | +\$1,194 |
| FundingPips     | 1-Step             | \$555 | 10/6% static                            | 80% × \$6k  | 37%      | \$5,120 | +\$1,326 | +\$1,158 |
| FundingPips     | Zero (instant)     | \$499 | instant                                 | 95% × \$5k  | 100%     | \$1,679 | +\$1,180 | +\$1,113 |
| E8 Markets †    | E8 One (6% DD)     | \$464 | 9/6% EOD trail                          | 80% × \$6k  | 39%      | \$3,920 | +\$1,079 | +\$514   |
| Goat Funded †   | 3-Step GOAT        | \$365 | 6/8% static → 6/8% static → 6/8% static | 80% × \$8k  | 18%      | \$6,272 | +\$767   | +\$598   |
| FundingPips     | 2-Step Pro         | \$399 | 6/6% static +cons. → 6/6% static +cons. | 80% × \$6k  | 24%      | \$4,704 | +\$726   | +\$635   |
| Maven †         | 3-Step             | \$269 | 3/3% static → 3/3% static → 3/3% static | 80% × \$3k  | 12%      | \$2,352 | +\$14    | +\$3     |
| Alpha Capital † | Alpha Three        | \$397 | 8/6% static → 8/6% static → 8/6% static | 80% × \$6k  | 8%       | \$4,704 | −\$39    | −\$95    |

| Firm               | Account                     | Price            | Target / max loss            | Funded        | P(fund.) | Value   | EV     | 1% risk |
|--------------------|-----------------------------|------------------|------------------------------|---------------|----------|---------|--------|---------|
| Lucid              | Direct 50K (instant)        | \$520            | instant                      | 90% × \$2k    | 100%     | \$1,458 | +\$938 | +\$908  |
| Apex               | 50K EOD                     | \$58 +\$139      | \$3k/\$2k EOD trail          | 100% × \$2k   | 39%      | \$1,620 | +\$525 | +\$352  |
| Bulenox            | 50K Opt.2 (EOD)             | \$175/mo +\$143k | \$3k/\$2.5k EOD trail +cons. | 100% × \$2.5k | 36%      | \$2,028 | +\$502 | +\$482  |
| Lucid              | Flex 50K                    | \$130            | \$3k/\$2k EOD trail          | 90% × \$2k    | 40%      | \$1,458 | +\$446 | +\$274  |
| Tradeify           | Growth 50K                  | \$139            | \$3k/\$2k EOD trail          | 90% × \$2k    | 39%      | \$1,458 | +\$435 | +\$265  |
| Tradeify           | Lightning 25K (instant)     | \$329            | instant                      | 90% × \$1k    | 100%     | \$723   | +\$394 | +\$379  |
| Lucid              | Pro 50K                     | \$185            | \$3k/\$2k EOD trail          | 90% × \$2k    | 39%      | \$1,458 | +\$389 | +\$219  |
| Topstep            | Combine 50K (Standard)      | \$49/mo +\$143k  | \$3k/\$2k EOD trail +cons.   | 90% × \$2k    | 32%      | \$1,470 | +\$375 | +\$316  |
| Topstep            | Combine 50K (No-Activation) | \$109/mo         | \$3k/\$2k EOD trail +cons.   | 90% × \$2k    | 32%      | \$1,470 | +\$363 | +\$298  |
| My Funded Futures  | Flex 50K                    | \$107/mo         | \$3k/\$2k EOD trail +cons.   | 80% × \$2k    | 32%      | \$1,296 | +\$309 | +\$252  |
| Tradeify           | Select 50K                  | \$159            | \$3k/\$2k EOD trail +cons.   | 90% × \$2k    | 29%      | \$1,458 | +\$270 | +\$245  |
| The5ers †          | Futures Basecamp 50K        | \$100            | \$3k/\$1.5k static           | 80% × \$1.5k  | 33%      | \$980   | +\$222 | +\$202  |
| Apex               | 50K Intraday                | \$32 +\$99       | \$3k/\$2k intraday           | 100% × \$2k   | 22%      | \$672   | +\$92  | +\$86   |
| Bulenox            | 50K Opt.1 (intraday)        | \$175/mo +\$143k | \$3k/\$2.5k intraday         | 100% × \$2.5k | 29%      | \$848   | +\$31  | +\$21   |
| Take Profit Trader | PRO 50K                     | \$170 +\$130     | \$3k/\$2k EOD trail          | 80% × \$2k    | 40%      | \$565   | +\$2   | -\$53   |
| My Funded Futures  | Rapid 50K                   | \$157/mo         | \$3k/\$2k intraday           | 90% × \$2k    | 22%      | \$604   | -\$26  | -\$31   |

# Method and sources

## How the numbers were produced

- **Exact results** (Chapters 3–6) follow from the formulas shown and were reproduced by a coin-flip simulation of 200,000 attempts (EV +\$2,272 ± 31 against the exact +\$2,235).
- **Evaluation phases for other firms** were solved by dynamic programming over balance and end-of-day high-water mark, with daily loss limits, best-day caps and a cost of  $\kappa\sqrt{wl}$  per bracket.
- **Funded values** use the identity of Chapter 5 with lock levels and payout caps.
- **Real-data tests** use hourly EURUSD (yfinance), 18 Dec 2023 – 2 Oct 2026, as described in Chapter 14.

## Sources

- FTMO, Trading Objectives: [ftmo.com/en/trading-objectives](https://ftmo.com/en/trading-objectives)
- FTMO, Forbidden Trading Practices: [ftmo.com/en/forbidden-trading-practices](https://ftmo.com/en/forbidden-trading-practices)
- FTMO, 1-Step Challenge: [ftmo.com/en/1-step-challenge](https://ftmo.com/en/1-step-challenge)
- Topstep, Express Funded Account parameters: [help.topstep.com](https://help.topstep.com)
- PropFirmsFinder program pages (FTMO, Topstep, Apex, The5ers, FundedNext, FundingPips, E8 Markets, Alpha Capital, Blue Guardian, Maven, Goat Funded Trader, Tradeify, Lucid, Take Profit Trader, My Funded Futures, Bulenox): [propfirmsfinder.com](https://propfirmsfinder.com)
- Apex Trader Funding payout caps: [thepropjournalist.com/reviews/apex-trader-funding](https://thepropjournalist.com/reviews/apex-trader-funding); PA rules: [traderssecondbrain.com](https://traderssecondbrain.com)
- Tradeify, Lucid, Take Profit Trader, FundedNext rule guides: [tradetanto.com](https://tradetanto.com), [proptradingvibes.com](https://proptradingvibes.com)
- Pass-rate estimates: [traderssecondbrain.com/guides/prop-firm-pass-rate](https://traderssecondbrain.com/guides/prop-firm-pass-rate)
- Prop firm closures: [tradernotion.com](https://tradernotion.com); [fxnewsgroup.com](https://fxnewsgroup.com) (True Forex Funds)

Rules and prices change frequently. Every figure is a snapshot from October 2026 and should be re-checked against the firm's current terms.

## Versions 3–4: firm rules and sources

Collected in October 2026 from the firms' own pages where possible and otherwise from review sites. Prices change with promotions; the fee used is shown in Chapter 20. Check every item against the firm's current terms before buying.

| Topic                                                                           | Source                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FTMO: accounts, \$400,000 cap, identical strategies                             | <a href="https://ftmo.com/en/faq/how-many-accounts-can-i-have/">ftmo.com/en/faq/how-many-accounts-can-i-have/</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| FTMO: monitored behaviour, forbidden practices, account rolling                 | <a href="https://ftmo.com/en/blog/why-ftmo-monitors-certain-patterns-in-trading-behaviour/">ftmo.com/en/blog/why-ftmo-monitors-certain-patterns-in-trading-behaviour/</a> ;<br><a href="https://ftmo.com/en/forbidden-trading-practices/">ftmo.com/en/forbidden-trading-practices/</a>                                            |
| FTMO: 1-Step / 2-Step rules, news and weekend, minimum days                     | <a href="https://propfirmbriefing.com/prop-firm-rules/ftmo/">propfirmbriefing.com/prop-firm-rules/ftmo/</a> ; <a href="https://tradetanto.com">tradetanto.com</a> (FTMO rules)                                                                                                                                                    |
| FundingPips: models, Flex, payouts, caps, risk per trade idea, copying, weekend | <a href="https://proptradingvibes.com/blog/fundingpips-rules/">proptradingvibes.com/blog/fundingpips-rules/</a> ; <a href="https://help.fundingpips.com">help.fundingpips.com</a> (2 Step Flex);<br><a href="https://fundingpips.com/blog/fundingpips-maximum-allocation">fundingpips.com/blog/fundingpips-maximum-allocation</a> |
| FundedNext: caps, prohibited strategies, copy-trading rule                      | <a href="https://help.fundednext.com">help.fundednext.com</a> (How many accounts; Restricted/Prohibited Trading Strategies; Copy Trading Rule)                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| The5ers: High Stakes, prohibited practices, copying, programs                   | <a href="https://the5ers.com/high-stakes/">the5ers.com/high-stakes/</a> ; <a href="https://the5ers.com/faqs/prohibited-trading-practices/">the5ers.com/faqs/prohibited-trading-practices/</a> ;<br><a href="https://propfirmbridge.com">propfirmbridge.com</a>                                                                    |
| Alpha Capital: rules, risk limit, caps, prohibited strategies                   | <a href="https://tradetanto.com">tradetanto.com</a> (Alpha Capital rules); <a href="https://help.alphacapitalgroup.uk">help.alphacapitalgroup.uk</a> ; <a href="https://propvator.com">propvator.com</a>                                                                                                                          |
| FXIFY: programmes, copy-trading approval, cap                                   | <a href="https://tradingfinder.com/props/fxify/rules/">tradingfinder.com/props/fxify/rules/</a> ; <a href="https://fxify.com">fxify.com</a> FAQs; <a href="https://propvator.com/blog/fxify-max-capital-allocation/">propvator.com/blog/fxify-max-capital-allocation/</a>                                                         |
| GFT: prohibited practices (duplicates, marketed strategies), cap                | <a href="https://help.goatfundedtrader.com">help.goatfundedtrader.com</a> (What are Prohibited Trading Practices?); <a href="https://propvator.com">propvator.com</a>                                                                                                                                                             |
| BrightFunded: 2-Step Classic, cap, refund, copying, prohibited practices        | <a href="https://tradetanto.com">tradetanto.com</a> (BrightFunded rules); <a href="https://proptradingvibes.com">proptradingvibes.com</a> (BrightFunded);<br><a href="https://tradingfinder.com">tradingfinder.com</a>                                                                                                            |
| Blue Guardian: 2-Step, Guardian Shield, cap, copying                            | <a href="https://help.blueguardian.com">help.blueguardian.com</a> (2 Step Standard Rules); <a href="https://blueguardian.com">blueguardian.com</a> blog (Guardian Shield)                                                                                                                                                         |
| FunderPro: Classic, cap, risk per trade, replication rule                       | <a href="https://support.funderpro.com">support.funderpro.com</a> ; <a href="https://thetrustedprop.com">thetrustedprop.com</a> ; <a href="https://traderfuel.net">traderfuel.net</a>                                                                                                                                             |
| Maven: 2-Step, cap, payout cap, copying                                         | <a href="https://propfirmmatch.com">propfirmmatch.com</a> (Maven); <a href="https://thepropfirmguide.com">thepropfirmguide.com</a> ; <a href="https://propfirmsradar.com">propfirmsradar.com</a>                                                                                                                                  |
| Apex, Topstep, Tradeify, Lucid: rules, prices, payouts, account limits          | <a href="https://proptradingvibes.com">proptradingvibes.com</a> (Apex, Topstep, Lucid); <a href="https://phidiaspropfirm.com">phidiaspropfirm.com</a> (Tradeify);<br><a href="https://blog.traderspost.io">blog.traderspost.io</a>                                                                                                |

### D.1 Method in one paragraph

Synthetic paths: 12 years of hourly bars, zero-drift random walk at the market's hourly volatility (Nasdaq 0.27%), exact Brownian-bridge extremes, weekends closed; eight independent paths for portfolios. Costs: 0.0064% of notional per round trip (US100 CFD), 0.0108% (gold), 0.0027% (micro futures), plus financing. 24,000 synthetic and 8,000 real-path attempts per programme; portfolios from the lockstep engine (all accounts on one path and calendar, shared direction enforced).

# Version 5: sources

| Topic                                                                                        | Source (read 4 October 2026)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| TrustPilot status of every firm in Chapter 33                                                | <a href="https://trustpilot.com/review/">trustpilot.com/review/</a> ( <a href="https://ftmo.com">ftmo.com</a> , <a href="https://the5ers.com">the5ers.com</a> , <a href="https://fundingpips.com">fundingpips.com</a> , <a href="https://fundednext.com">fundednext.com</a> , <a href="https://fxify.com">fxify.com</a> , <a href="https://holaprime.com">holaprime.com</a> , <a href="https://fintokei.com">fintokei.com</a> , <a href="https://alphacapitalgroup.uk">alphacapitalgroup.uk</a> , <a href="https://maventrading.com">maventrading.com</a> , <a href="https://brightfunded.com">brightfunded.com</a> , <a href="https://blueguardian.com">blueguardian.com</a> , <a href="https://funderpro.com">funderpro.com</a> , <a href="https://goatfundedtrader.com">goatfundedtrader.com</a> ) |
| Safety grades, account limits, current prices                                                | <a href="https://propfirmmap.com/firms/">propfirmmap.com/firms/</a> (each firm); <a href="https://propfirmmap.com/trust-check">propfirmmap.com/trust-check</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Blue Guardian, Audacity, AquaFunded suspensions (August 2025)                                | <a href="https://tradeinformer.com/broker-news/several-props-suspended-from-trustpilot-due-to-fake-reviews">tradeinformer.com/broker-news/several-props-suspended-from-trustpilot-due-to-fake-reviews</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Fintokei ProTrader: plan table, terms (sign-up bonus = fee, €500,000, billing every 14 days) | <a href="https://fintokei.com/protrader/">fintokei.com/protrader/</a> ; <a href="https://fintokei.com/downloads/Fintokei_provider_program_TaC_ProTrader_FPP.pdf">fintokei.com/downloads/Fintokei_provider_program_TaC_ProTrader_FPP.pdf</a> ; <a href="https://support.fintokei.com">support.fintokei.com</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| Hola Prime: 2-Step Prime rules; prohibited practices (copying, hedging, one-sided betting)   | <a href="https://holaprime.com/forex/faq/hola-prime-challenges/hola-prime-2-step-prime-challenge/">holaprime.com/forex/faq/hola-prime-challenges/hola-prime-2-step-prime-challenge/</a> ; <a href="https://holaprime.com/trading-rules-list/trading-rules-prohibited-trading-practices/">holaprime.com/trading-rules-list/trading-rules-prohibited-trading-practices/</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| The5ers High Stakes account limits and prices                                                | <a href="https://the5ers.com/high-stakes/">the5ers.com/high-stakes/</a> ; <a href="https://propfirmbridge.com">propfirmbridge.com</a> (The5ers High Stakes review)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| OANDA Prop Trader rules and closure                                                          | <a href="https://legal.oanda.com">legal.oanda.com</a> (Rules for Trading Challenges, 30 Jan 2026); <a href="https://quantvps.com">quantvps.com</a> (OANDA Prop Trader overview)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| Topstep prices, resets, Express Funded limits                                                | <a href="https://help.topstep.com">help.topstep.com</a> (pricing and payment questions); <a href="https://proptradingvibes.com">proptradingvibes.com</a> (Topstep Combine rules, September 2026)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| Apex 4.0 rules, account limit, copying, discounts                                            | <a href="https://phidiaspropfirm.com">phidiaspropfirm.com</a> (Apex 4.0 explained); <a href="https://apextraderfunding.com">apextraderfunding.com</a> help centre; <a href="https://propfirmmap.com">propfirmmap.com</a> (Apex)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| FundedNext copying once funded; FXIFY copying approval                                       | <a href="https://help.fundednext.com">help.fundednext.com</a> ; <a href="https://fxify.com">fxify.com</a> FAQs (2 Phase Pro copy trading)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Blueberry Funded, ThinkCapital, FTUK, E8, Funded Trading Plus                                | <a href="https://help.blueberryfunded.com">help.blueberryfunded.com</a> ; <a href="https://thinkcapital.com">thinkcapital.com</a> (Dual Step); <a href="https://faq.ftuk.com">faq.ftuk.com</a> (Two-Step Program Rules); <a href="https://tradetanto.com">tradetanto.com</a> (E8 rules); <a href="https://propvator.com">propvator.com</a> (Funded Trading Plus)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |